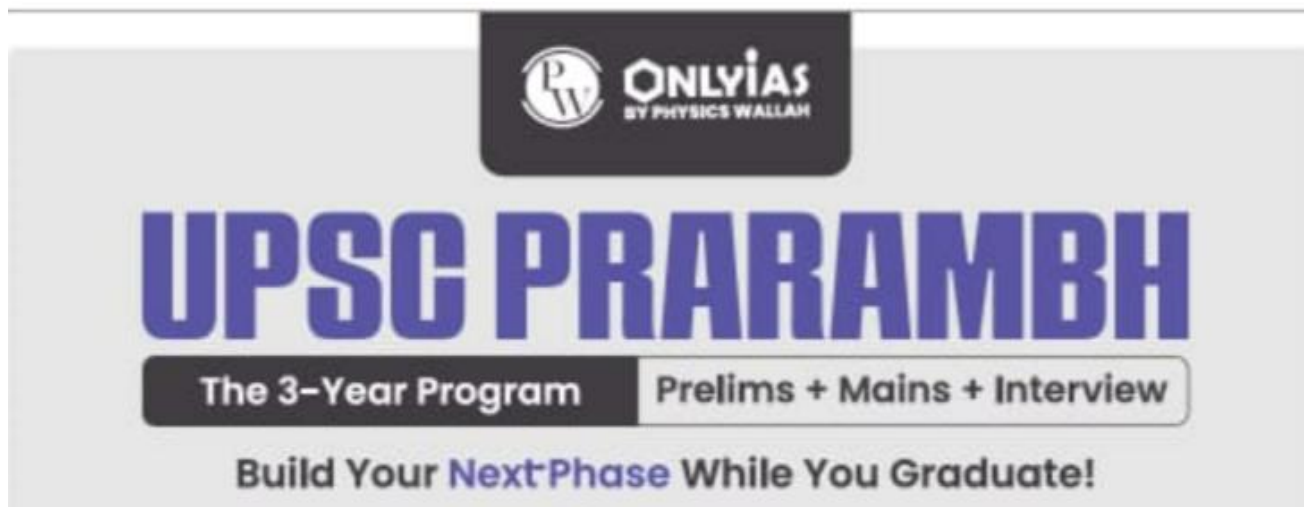




Compilation of DAILY CLASS NOTES

Medieval History



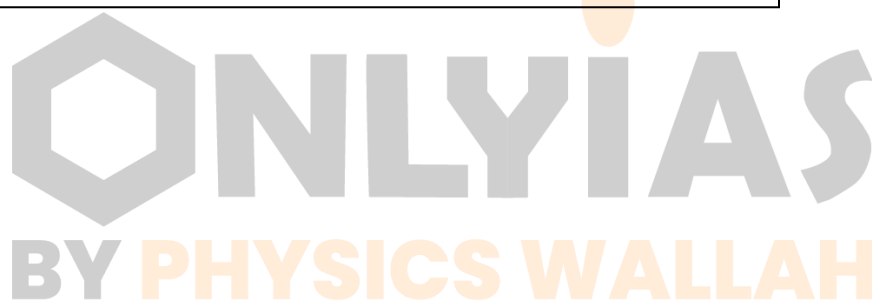


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Lecture -01

Introduction to the Early Medieval Period



Introduction to the Early Medieval Period



Outline of Lecture

- ❖ Overview of Medieval History
- ❖ New and Old Terminologies
- ❖ Time Period and Sources
- ❖ Political, Economic, Social, and Religious Transformations
- ❖ Advent of Islam in India
- ❖ Conclusion

Overview of Medieval History:

- ❖ As history is a **process of continuous evolution**; various changes take place over a thousand years, there has been contention between historians concerning its **time**, and Medieval History can be divided into **two parts**.
- ❖ The period of Indian medieval history differs from that of the **European medieval period**. In Europe, the time between the **7th to 18th centuries** is considered to be the medieval age. But, India did not undergo its medieval age during this exact time frame.
- ❖ India had her medieval age begin with the **decline of Harshavardha of the Pushyabhuti Dynasty**. The period continued till the **death of Aurangzeb in 1707**. So, in India, the medieval age stretched between the **7th to 18th centuries**.
 - According to some historians, the complete features of the medieval age cannot be traced between the **7th and 12th centuries**.
 - ✓ To them, the right period to consider the beginning of the medieval age in India would be dating back to the time when **Mohammad Ghori** attacked India.
 - ✓ To them, the period between the **7th to 12th centuries** would be rightly termed the **Early Medieval Period**.
 - ✓ The period after the 12th to the 18th century would be the medieval period of India.

❖ The varied history of North India runs parallel to the history of South India in both the medieval and early medieval periods.

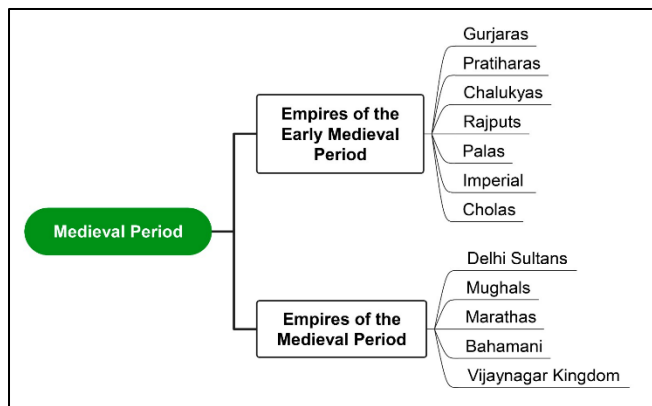
❖ Empires which developed:

➤ Early medieval period in north India:

Several small kingdoms of Gurjaras, Pratiharas, Chalukyas, Rajputs, and Palas rose to prominence.

✓ The period witnessed multiple Islamic invasions like that of Kasim, Mahmud of Ghazni, etc. because of the internal weaknesses

of the small kingdoms. So, in simple terms, the northern states were fragmented as compared to the southern empire.



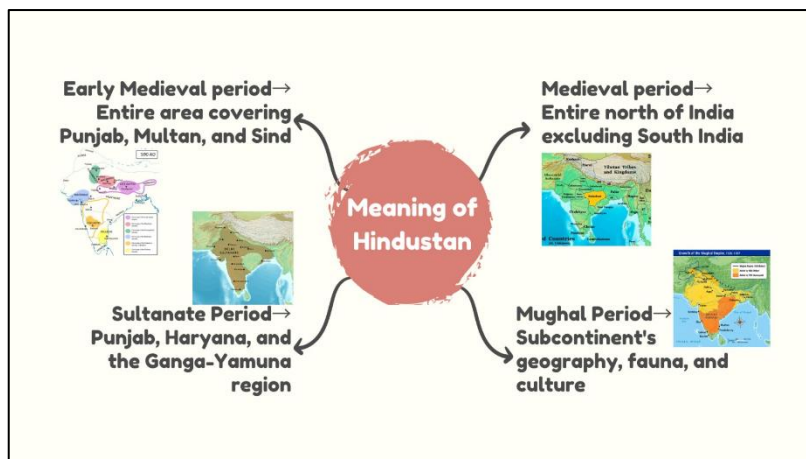
➤ Early medieval period in South India: The imperial Cholas rose during this period.

➤ Medieval Age in North India: This period saw the rise in power of the Delhi Sultans (Sultanate Period), followed by the Mughals, and the evolution of the Marathas.

➤ Medieval period in South India: The famous Vijayanagar and the Bahmani Kingdom rose to prominence during this time frame.

New and Old Terminologies:

❖ Every period has a specific term whose meaning is restricted just to a particular timeline. The meaning it has in one period might differ when used or understood in some period. For example., during the Early Medieval period, Hindustan meant the entire area that covered Punjab, Multan, and Sindh for the Arabians, Turks, and other foreigners who invaded India.



- ❖ In the medieval period, the term *Hindustan* meant the entire north of India but it never included South India. It thereby implies that the meaning of *Hindustan* varied over time.
 - **Sultanate Period:** "*Hindustan*" exemplifies changing meanings originally referred to areas like Punjab, Haryana, and the Ganga-Yamuna region during the Delhi Sultanate.
 - **Mughal Period:** Babur, in the 16th century, used "*Hindustan*" to denote the subcontinent's geography, fauna, and culture. This idea was echoed by Poet Amir Khusrau in his works in the 14th century.
- ❖ **Modern Time:** This meaning of "*Hindustan*" lacked modern political and national connotations in the past. Historians must be cautious. For example, "*Foreigner*" meant any stranger in medieval times, not limited to nationality. Words like "*Pardesi*" (Hindi) and "*Ajnabi*" (Persian) convey similar ideas in modern Hindi, unlike in medieval times.
- ❖ **Thinking About Time:** Historians perceive time shifts in social and economic structures, the evolution of ideas, and the transformation of beliefs. For example, in the 19th century, British historians divided India's history into three periods "*Hindu*," "*Muslim*," and "*British*," neglecting other pivotal changes in economy, society, and culture.
- ❖ **Contemporary historians-** economic and social factors- peasant societies, the ascendancy of regional and imperial states.

Time Period and Sources:

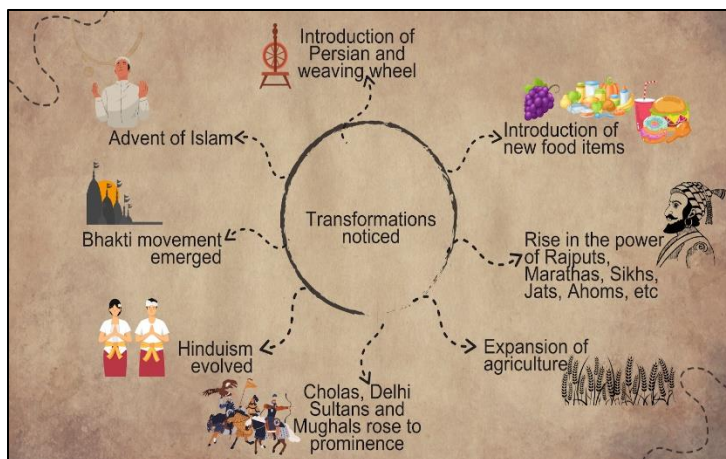
- ❖ From the perspective of History, time is equated with change in society, economy, and polity.
- ❖ Britishers divided Indian history into three parts- Hindu history, Muslim history, and British history.
 - The issue with this categorization was that the entire segregation was done based on religion. Questions could also be raised if the first two periods were based on two religions.
 - The third period of history writing- British history was not referred to as the period of Christian history. Also, there was no consideration for socio-economic changes.

- ❖ **Modern historians** classified history into three parts– **Ancient, Medieval, and Modern.**
 - The **socio-economic changes** were considered in this classification. This classification too had its **loopholes** considering that there were **numerous changes in the society, economy, and polity** of the medieval times, referring to **non-homogeneity**.
 - The debate between historians referring to the timeline of the medieval and early medieval falls under the same line because there were **differences noticed in the processes of state formation, administrative strategies, etc, and generalizing the entire period into one was inappropriate.**
- ❖ **Sources:** To decipher the **Mauryan period**, historians relied more on the **manuscripts, inscriptions, and coinage.** Even though **written history** was available, the **dependency** on these accounts was **less.** Now, coming to the **medieval era**, **more stress** is given to **written sources** because **paper** was readily available which helped in writing down history.
 - **Problems with written sources:**
 - ✓ **Non-availability of the printing press:** Even though paper was made readily available, the **printing press** was not invented during that period. So to have a **copy of a book**, it had to be **written by hand** which could have led to **increased mistakes in the accounts.**
 - ✓ **Issues in translation**
 - ✓ **Differences in the writing:** Differences in the writing of the **same historians for two different periods.** Example: **Ziauddin Barauni**, who used to write chronicles wrote parts of it in years with long gaps in between. His 14th-century chronicle which has two parts and differences has been noticed in his writings.
 - ✓ **Rare availability of original manuscripts:** Whatever is available is mostly translated, translated, and unreliable because of multiple mistakes in the facts written.



Political, Economic, Social, and Religious Transformations:

- ❖ **Innovation leading to transformation:** The Persian wheel attached to buckets was invented to help in the easy drawing of water and accelerating irrigational mechanism. Along with this, the weaving wheel was discovered which eased out textile production. A few new vegetables like potatoes, tomatoes, coffee, tea, chilies, corn, etc were introduced into the Indian subcontinent. Any new commodity introduced would reflect a change in our behavior. This change was reflected in every field.



- **Social transformation:** An increased mobility was witnessed as people traveled extensively in search of better opportunities. We can also see the emergence of new political groups like Rajput, Marathas, Sikhs, Jats, Ahoms, and Kayasthas who seized opportunities for political influence. The jatis or caste and sub-castes rose to prominence and reached its dominance. Even the villages were ruled by Jati Panchayats (village panchayats).
- **Economy transformation:** The gradual clearing of forests led to the expansion of agriculture. Changes forced forest dwellers to migrate while others turned to farming and became peasants. Peasants came under the influence of regional markets, chieftains, religious institutions, zamindars, and temples.
- **Political transformation:** Powerful dynasties like the Cholas, Tughlaqs, and Mughals rose to prominence and governed vast territories. Various textual sources gave detailed information about these dynasties but sometimes historians feel that certain events or even the emperor's conquests were exaggerated.
 - ✓ For example, a Sanskrit prashasti hailed Delhi Sultan, Ghiyasuddin Balban as a vast empire from Bengal in the East to Ghazni (Afghanistan) in the West and also included the whole of South India. The Mughal decline in the 18th century led to the resurgence of regional states.

- ❖ **Religious Transformation:** Hinduism evolved. New deities were worshipped, and temples were constructed under royal patronage. Brahmanas, or priests, gained prominence. The period also witnessed the emergence of the **Bhakti Movement** which was based on the concept of a loving, personal deity accessible without priestly intervention or elaborate rituals.
 - **New Religions introduced:** Merchants and migrants introduced the teachings of the holy Quran that led to the advent of Islam affirming the sovereignty of one God, Allah, Shia Muslims followed the leadership of Ali, while Sunni Muslims accepted early leaders (Caliphas) and their successors.

Advent of Islam in India:

- ❖ Between 640 and 709 AD, a big Islamic Empire Umayyad Caliphate of the Quraysh tribe evolved across Asia, Europe, and Africa.
 - The Ottoman Empire referred to as the Caliphate was ruled by Calipha who was similar to the king.
 - The difference lay in terms of power vested with him. The Calipha had the right to exercise both political and religious rights whereas the kings only had political rights.
- ❖ The entire Caliphate was divided into several kingdoms. The two most important were the Iraqi province and Fers which later became Persia and today's Iran.
- ❖ The governor of Arabia, Al Hajjaj (Iraqi province) sent his son-in-law Muhammad Bin Qasim to conquer Sindh in 712 AD.
- ❖ A few ships carrying goods were crossing the Arabian Sea in 712 AD when the sailors were attacked and looted by the pirates. During this period Dahir was the king of Sindh (Hindu King of a Hindu-dominated area).
- ❖ Al-Walid I who was the Calipha at that time blamed



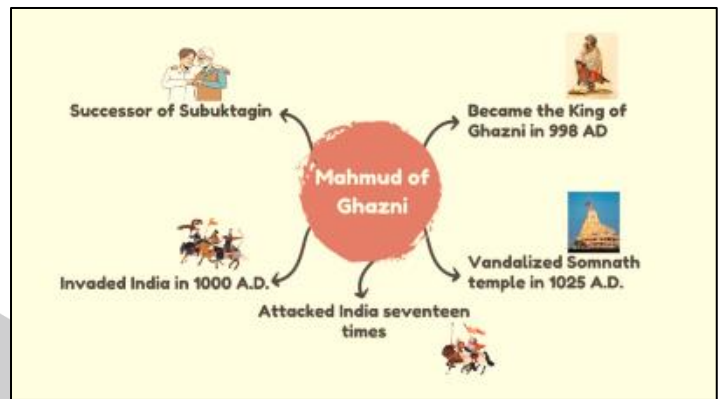
Dahir for the piracy. Because Dahir was not ready to compensate for Caliph's loss, he got into an alliance with Al Hajjaj to defeat him.

- ❖ In 712 AD, Muhammad Bin Qasim who was on good terms with Walid I attacked Dahir and was defeated and killed.
 - Both of Dahir's sons were killed when Qasim tried to capture Brahmanabad. Dahir's daughters were absconded to present them as gifts to the Caliph. But, Qaim's fortune did not favor him for long. During the entire period of tumult, Al Walid I died all of a sudden.
 - After this, Caliph Walid was succeeded by Caliph Sulaiman who was the younger brother of Walid. But, the new Caliph was an enemy of both Al-Hajjaj and Muhammad-bin Qasim.
 - When the daughters of Dahir were presented in front of Sulaiman, they announced that both of them were not pure and that Qasim was trying to trick him, as Qasim had already spent time with them privately before presenting them to the Caliph. Post that both of Dahir's daughters died by suicide.
 - Angered by the narrative, Qasim was presented dead tied with the skin of an ox. The entire story is written with the title Chach Nama by Ali Kufi.
 - The literary work got its name Chachnama because Sindh was also known as Chachas. The Brahmin dynasty of Sindh (c. 632 – 712), also known as the Chacha dynasty, was the ruling dynasty of Sindh, succeeding the Rai dynasty. Whatever may have been Qasim's fate, his attack on India was considered to be the first Islamic attack.
- ❖ The advent of Islam in India- Mahmud Ghaznavi (Second prominent attack)
 - Subuktagin, a Turkish local official, organized a small kingdom in Ghazni in Afghanistan at the end of the 10th century AD.
 - After the death of Subuktagin, his son Mahmud became the king of Ghazni in 998 AD transforming the kingdom of Ghazni into an empire.
 - In 1000 A.D. Mahmud of Ghazni invaded India for the first time and since then, he attacked India seventeen times on Indian Territory. He just wanted to attack India to loot its enormous wealth and not settle his kingdom in India.

- Mahmud's significant invasion in Hindustan was against the **Somnath temple** (Kathiawar region of Gujarat) in **1025 A.D.**



- ✓ Raja Bhima Dev, the ruler of Kathiawar during this period of invasion escaped with his nobles from the place. This gave zero resistance to Mahmud. Thus, he invaded without any restriction.
- ✓ During this loot, he massacred around **fifty thousand civilians**, and the **deities at the temple were disfigured and destroyed**.
- ✓ Along with this, he looted **1300 kg of gold** along with **millions of dinars**.



Conclusion:

- ❖ The **16th and 18th centuries** stood distinctly apart from the **8th or 11th centuries**. Hence, categorizing the entire period as a **single historical entity** poses challenges.
- ❖ Additionally, the **contrast between the "medieval" and "modern" periods** is common. "Modernity" implies **material progress and intellectual advancement**, potentially suggesting a lack of change during the medieval era. Yet, we understand that significant transformations marked the medieval period.



ONLYIAS
BY PHYSICS WALLAH

Lecture -02

Important Dynasties in the Early Medieval Period



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Important Dynasties in the Early Medieval Period



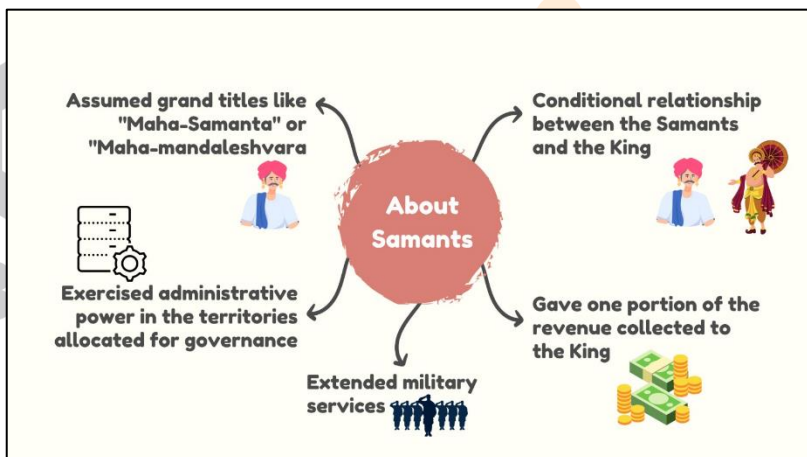
- ❖ Introduction
- ❖ Administration in the Kingdoms
- ❖ Prashastis as Propaganda
- ❖ Source of Wealth
- ❖ Imperial Cholas

Introduction:

- ❖ 8th century onwards, a complex political system of regional power structures evolved.

These kingdoms were small in terms of the territories they ruled over.

➤ What complicated the system was that the Rajas of the particular dynasty were not able to rule alone so he divided and gave some portions of the



kingdoms to the influential feudal landlords and warrior chiefs-samantas for administrative purposes. This system, with the king being the head and the samants being responsible under him is referred to as the “Samanti” system.

- ❖ A conditional relationship developed between the king and the Samant. The king gave the samants some parts of the territory and in return, the samants gave one portion of the revenue collected to the king.
- ❖ Whenever summoned to the court, the samantas had to be present, and extended military support when required.

- ❖ The land gave **social status** to the samants along with several other **privileges** like **political power**. The entire system was **complex** because these samants turned out to be **very powerful** whereas the **king** became **dependent** on the samants.
- ❖ The entire political structure was **decentralized** where power was divided into several groups, making the **king less powerful**.
- ❖ Becoming extremely powerful, these samantas assumed **grand titles** like "maha-samanta" or "Maha-mandaleshvara." The Kings attained titles like "Maharaja-adhiraja" and "Tribhuvana-chakravartin".
- ❖ Sometimes, they even **asserted their independence** and became **autonomous rulers**.
 - For example, Rashtrakutas were the **subordinates (samantas)** of the **Chalukyas** of Karnataka, but later on, the Rashtrakuta chief **Dantidurga** overthrew his **Chalukya overlord** in the mid-eighth century CE, marking the beginning of Rashtrakuta empire.
 - ✓ **Dantidurga** performed rituals like the "**Hiranya-garbha**," which was believed to lead to a "**rebirth**" as a **Kshatriya (warrior class)**.
 - Similarly, the **Cholas** were the samantas of the **Pallava kings**. From upon the Chola samantas, **Vijaylala I** overthrew the **Pallava king** and took over the throne.
 - ✓ Even the chiefs from non-military backgrounds developed Dynasties for example- **Mayursharma** (Brahmin) founded the **Kadamba Dynasty** in Karnataka.
 - ✓ **Nagabhatta I** did the same in **Rajasthan** and **Gujarat** and developed the **Gurjara-Pratihara dynasty**.



Other dynasties to ponder upon:

- ❖ **Kadamba Dynasty:**
 - Following the **decline of Satavahanas**, Karnataka experienced **political instability** until the **Kadambas of Banavasi** gained prominence. With the **Western Ganga**

Dynasty as their contemporaries, the Kadambas established the first independent native kingdoms in the region.

- The Halmidi inscription provides proof that the Kadambas were the first monarchs to utilize Kannada as an official administrative language.
- The rulers adhered to Hinduism derived from Vedic texts. The founder was originally a Brahmin, but his successors eventually converted to being Kshatriya.

❖ **Gurjara-Pratihara Dynasty:**

- The area occupied by the Gurjara Pratiharas was frequently attacked by Arab travelers. At the peak of its supremacy, the Gurjar Pratihara state had Kannauj as its capital.
- The Gurjara-Pratihara monarchs had the most powerful position in the state and went by grand titles like "Parmeshwara," "Maharajadhiraja," and "Parambhatarak."

Administration in the Kingdoms:

- ❖ Complete authority was vested in the hands of the kings, but he had to share his territories with the samantas for good governance. These kings collected revenue which was used in the maintenance of the royal establishment, the construction of temples and forts, and the financing of military endeavors. Revenue was collected in three manners-
 - Resources were collected from the peasants, cattle-keepers, and artisans.
 - Revenue collected from Traders as they were an important source
 - Successful wars could lead to the acquisition of wealth through plunder.
- ❖ The samantas who held key positions in the administration, including those responsible for revenue collection and military command got the hereditary right to the position. This ensured continuity and loyalty within the ruling elite.

Prashastis as Propaganda:

- ❖ Prashastis were royal eulogies (songs of praise) or panegyric (glorification) texts composed by learned Brahmanas. Copper Plate Inscriptions also give us references to the granting of land to Brahmanas.

- ❖ These prashastis often contained *exaggerated or idealized accounts* or were *hyperbolic* concerning rulers' achievements. These prashastis were used as *propaganda* by the king to create a good image of him.
 - One such example is the *Prashasti on Nagabhata* (Pratihara king).
 - The *Uttaramerur Inscriptions* (Tamil Nadu) give a good account of the South Indian administration. It describes the presence of *separate committees* within the *sabha* responsible for various tasks, such as *irrigation works, gardens, justice, trade, and temple management*.
 - Kalhana's historical account, *Rajatarangini* was written in the *twelfth century*. *Rajatarangini* gives us an insight into the history of the *north-western Indian subcontinent, the kings of Kashmir*. Kalhana was known for his *Sanskrit poems* and was quite *critical* in his approach regarding the rulers and their policies.
 - ✓ So it can be clearly stated that he did not write his accounts under *royal patronage* but rather were his *independent creations*.

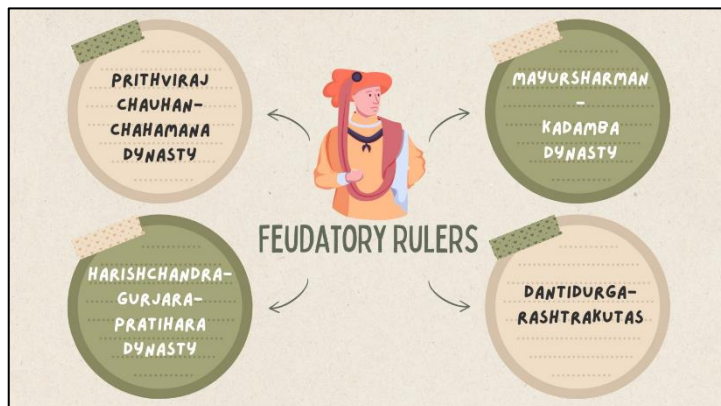


The Achievements of Nagabhata:

- ❖ Many rulers described their achievements in *prashasti*. One *prashasti*, written in *Sanskrit* and found in *Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh*, describes the *exploits of Nagabhata, a Pratihara king*, as follows:
 - The *kings of Andhra, Saindhava (Sind), Vidarbha (part of Maharashtra), and Kalinga (part of Orissa)* fell before him even as he was a prince.
 - He won a victory over *Chakrayudha (the ruler of Kanauj)*.
 - He defeated the *king of Vanga (part of Bengal)*. *Anarta (part of Gujarat), Malava (part of Madhya Pradesh), Kirata (forest people), Turushka (Turks), Vatsa Matsya (both kingdoms in north India)*.

Source of Wealth:

- ❖ Wars among Regional Dynasties and Power Struggles: Kanauj located in the Ganga Valley was a very controversial location.
 - Owing to the land's fertility and also being the center of trade, the Gurjara-Pratihara, Rashtrakuta, and Pala dynasties fought against each other to get control over the land. This struggle between the three dynasties was termed the "Tripartite Struggle" which continued for about 200 years.
 - In this period, the three dynasties ruled over Kannauj but eventually in the end, victory was attained by the Gurjara and Pratiharas who succeeded in attaining control over Kannauj.
- ❖ Temples as Symbols of Power: To showcase their power after defeating other kingdoms, the kings used to construct gigantic temples. These wars-targeted temples known for their riches were eyed by the invaders.
 - For example, the primary targets of Mahmud of Ghazni-raids between 1000 and 1025 CE, were the wealthy temples of India, including the famous Somnath temple in Gujarat.
- ❖ Expansionist Efforts: The Chahamanas, later known as the Chauhans, ruled over the Delhi and Ajmer regions and attempted to expand their rule westward and eastward-encountered with Chalukyas of Gujarat and the Gahadavalas of western Uttar Pradesh.
 - Prithviraj III was a Chahamana ruler who achieved a notable victory over an Afghan ruler named Sultan Muhammad Ghori in 1191 CE. However, he suffered defeat at Ghori's hands the following year, in 1192 CE.

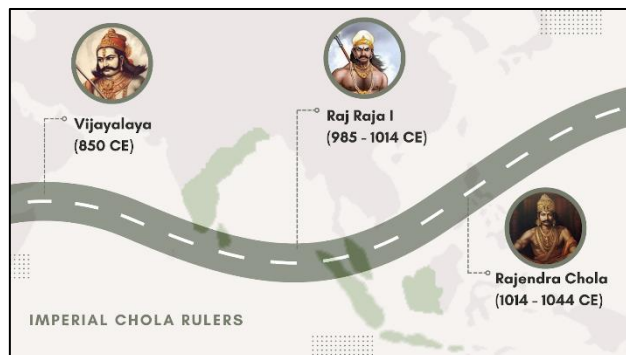


Imperial Cholas:

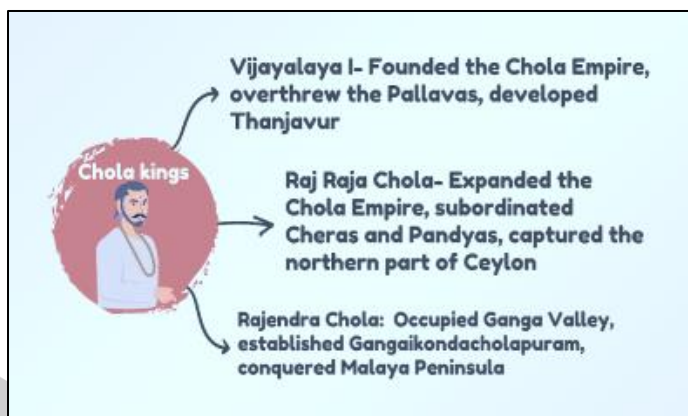
- ❖ The Cholas were referred to as the Imperial Cholas because they created an empire. Vijayalaya I who was the samant of Uraiyur under the Pallavas took control of the

territory and in the 9th century, he founded the Chola empire. Kanchipuram, the capital of Pallavas was subordinated.

- ❖ Vijayalaya I established his kingdoms across the delta of the Kaveri River. The Thanjavur city was developed by Vijayalaya I. After Vijayalaya I, Raj Raja Chola (985 AD) took over the throne under the expansion of the Chola empire.



- ❖ The Cheras and Pandyas were subordinated to some extent by Raja Raja Chola. He also attacked Ceylon and captured the northern part of Ceylon.

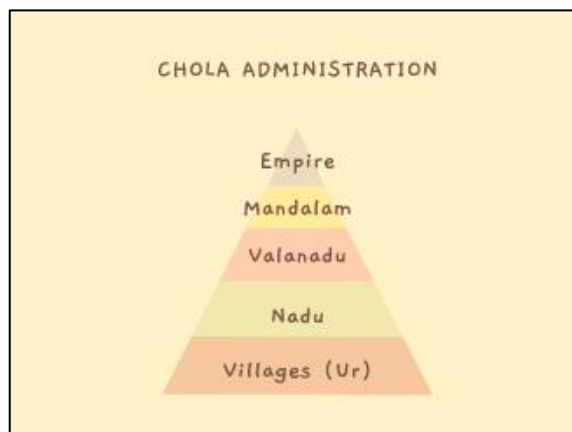


- ❖ After Raj Raja, Rajendra Chola came to power and was considered to be very powerful. It is believed that he won over the Ganga valley and occupied it.

- After winning over this region, he assumed the title of Gangaikonda Chola.
- A city was developed here after the title he assumed – Gangaikondacholapuram. Also, Sri Lanka was captured completely by him.
- The Malaya Peninsula in Southeast Asia was conquered and captured by the Chola dynasty.
- Rajendra Chola had a very strong navy with the help of which he conquered distant lands.

- ❖ The Chola administration:

- A very effective administrative structure was built by the Cholas. The entire system of Cholas was termed as the Empire.



- The **Mandalam** provinces made up the entire empire. The mandalams comprised several **Velanadus (kottams)** which in turn had multiple **nadus** in them. A group of villages known as **Urs** comprise each **Nadu**.
- These villages had **sabhas** and **samitis** which looked into the local administration of the state.
- ❖ **Temple construction under the Cholas:** The temples were built at **Thanjavur** and **Gangaikondacholapuram**. These temples were the **centre of the economy** as they had an enormous amount of wealth. Artisans, traders, dancers, and musicians were present in the temple premises.
- ❖ **Craftsmanship:** The Cholas were known for their art of making **bronze sculptures**. One such example is **Nataraja** which gives great artistic value. The quantity of the **copper objects** was very fine and intricate. **Bronze craftsmanship** was at a superior position.
- ❖ **Agriculture under the Cholas:** Agriculture was **expanded**. Most of the **Tamil Nadu** was under farming. The expansion of agriculture across the **delta of Kaveri** has been credited to the Cholas.
 - Wells were found which showed that the Cholas had the idea of **irrigational practices**. This irrigational facility helped in **increasing agricultural production**, contributing to the **revenue** of the empire.

Facts to Remember:

- ❖ **Vellanvagai:** Land was given to non-Brahmins
- ❖ **Brahmadeya:** Land grants to Brahmins
- ❖ **Shala Bhoga Land:** Land given to the maintenance of schools for Devdasis.
- ❖ **Tirunamattukkani:** Land grants given to temples
- ❖ **Pallichchandam:** Land grants given to Jaina institutions
- ❖ **Muvendavelan:** Titles given to peasants who served three kings
- ❖ **Kadmai:** Agricultural tax
- ❖ **Vettu:** Tax in the form of forced labor
- ❖ **Nagaram:** Association of traders

Lecture -03
Delhi Sultanate (Part - I)



Delhi Sultanate (Part - I)

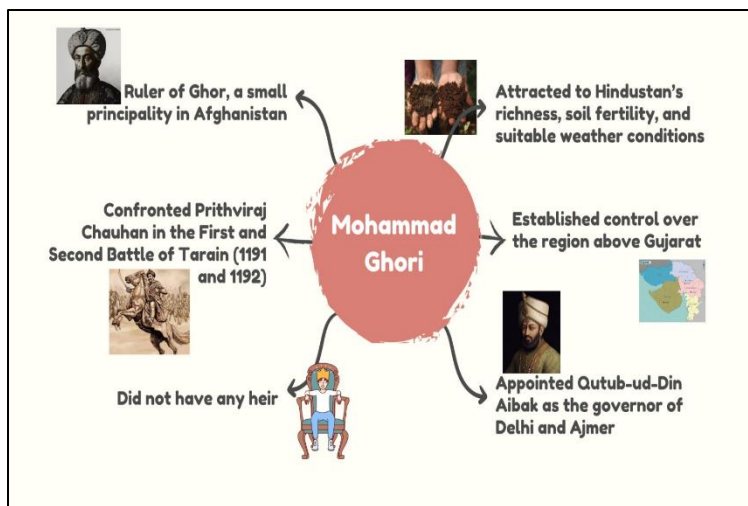


Outline of Lecture

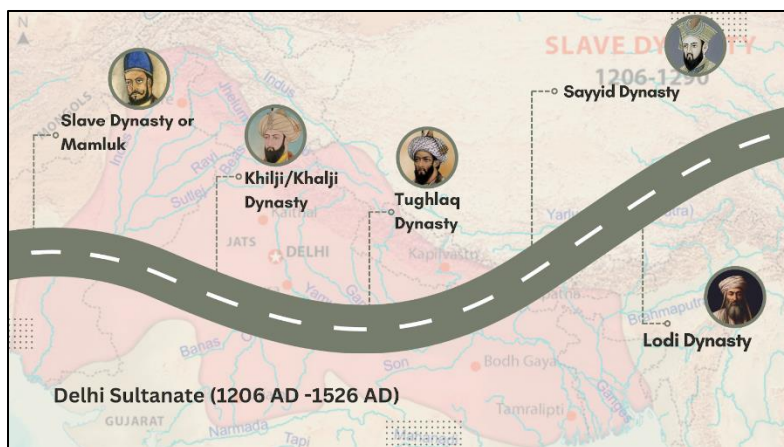
- ❖ Introduction
- ❖ The situation of India in the 12th Century and Struggle For Monarchy
- ❖ Slave Dynasty (1211-1236 AD)
- ❖ Razia Sultan (1236 - 1239 AD)
- ❖ The period between 1246-1266
 - Nasir-ud- Din Mahmud
- ❖ Balban (1266-1287 AD)

Introduction:

- ❖ Delhi and Ajmer did not play a significant role as a capital city until the 12th century AD. However, it became an important city under the rule of Tomara Rajputs and Chahamanas of Ajmer who later came to be known as Chauhans in this century.
- ❖ Anangpal Tomar was dethroned by the Chahamanas king Prithviraj Chauhan. It is believed in historical tales that Anangpal Tomar was Prithviraj Chauhan's maternal grandfather.
 - Because he did not have any heir to ascend the throne, Prithviraj Chauhan became the king but for the other side of the lineage (father's side as his marriage was married in the Chauhan dynasty).
- ❖ During the same period, there was a small principality in Afghanistan named Ghor. The small principality was expanded into a large empire by Mahmud of Ghor or Mohammad Ghor.



- For a very long period, he had an eye on the Indian subcontinent owing to its richness, fertility of soil, and suitable weather conditions, unlike Afghanistan where the weather was extremely harsh and unsuitable for any kind of cultivation. Because of this, finally, Md Ghorī attacked India and was confronted by Prithviraj Chauhan.
- In the First Battle of Tarain (1191) fought between the Ghorids and the Chauhans, Prithviraj Chauhan defeated the Ghurid sultan Mu'izz al-Din Ghorī. The latter went back to Afghanistan after the defeat. But Ghorī's commander made Ghorī understand that Prithviraj might come back and assassinate Ghorī.
 - ✓ But Rajputs have always had certain war principles- they never attacked someone who did not have arms or even one who was defeated in a war and pleaded for freedom. The principles of Kshatriya rulers were surely not followed by the Arabic and Afghan invaders.
 - ✓ So, sparing Ghorī is considered to be a grave mistake and after preparing for a year, Ghorī again attacked Delhi and the Ajmer region.
 - ✓ Now, in the Second Battle of Tarain (1192), Ghorī was very well prepped. In the Second Battle of Tarain in 1192, Muhammad of Ghor defeated the army of Prithviraj Chauhan, who was captured and killed.
- ❖ From Chand Bardai's Prithviraj Raso, we come to know that Ghorī took Prithviraj away to Ghor when he was horrendously tortured. However, questions came to be raised over the validity of whether Prithviraj was defeated and taken back to Afghanistan or not.
- According to Prithviraj Raso, Ghorī was killed by Prithviraj Chauhan at a later stage but historically, it cannot be proven so. Ghorī was alive for a long period and he died in 1206.
- ❖ After this incident at Tarain, Islamic rule came to be established full-fledgedly. Ghorī then established his control over the region above Gujarat. Even though Ghorī was alive till 1206, he had no heir.



- He used to state that all of his slaves were his sons. So, he appointed Qutub-ud-Din Aibak who was Ghori's slave and his military commander was appointed as the governor of Delhi and Ajmer.
- ✓ This marked the transformation of Delhi into a major capital city controlling vast areas began with the establishment of the Delhi Sultanate in the early thirteenth century.

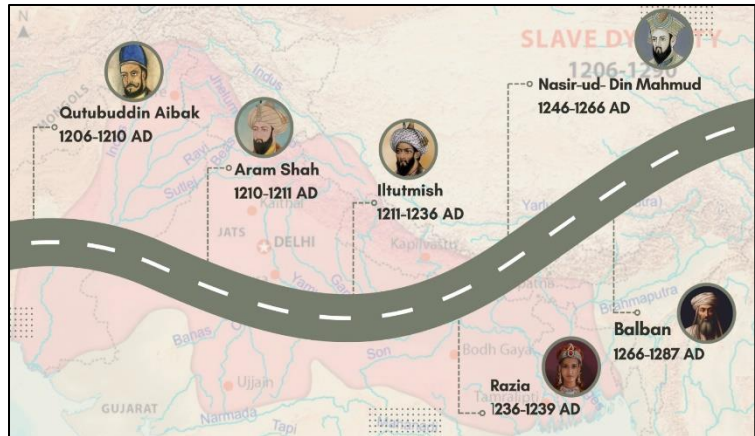
The situation of India in the 12th Century and Struggle For Monarchy:

- ❖ **Fragmented Political Landscape:** After the establishment of the Delhi Sultanate by Qutb-ud-din Aibak in 1206 AD, there were multiple rulers and dynasties, leading to a fragmented political landscape.
- ❖ **Autonomy of Iqtadars:** Powerful feudal lords and military commanders, known as Iqtadars (similar to samants), a practice that was started by Iqtadars held significant autonomy, challenging central authority.
- ❖ **External Threats and Invasion:** Invasions by Mongols and other external threats further destabilized the sultanate and diverted resources from centralization efforts.
- ❖ **Scattered administration and consolidation by Balban:** Some sultans successfully consolidated power, like Balban, who ruthlessly suppressed nobles and strengthened royal authority.
- ❖ **Attempted Administrative Reforms:** Several sultans, like Alauddin Khilji and Muhammad bin Tughluq, attempted administrative reforms to strengthen the monarchy, including tax reforms and centralization of power.
- ❖ **Influence of Religion:** The role of religious leaders and Ulemas in shaping the monarchy's policies and legitimacy was significant. Before the Islamic rulers came to India, Hinduism was dominant. So, Hinduism was suppressed and Islamic culture was forcibly introduced.
- ❖ **Influence of Persian Culture:** Persian culture and the Persian administrative system played a role in centralization efforts, unifying diverse regions.
- ❖ **Succession Disputes and Dynastic Conflicts:** Succession disputes and conflicts among different dynasties led to political instability, weakening the monarchy's control.

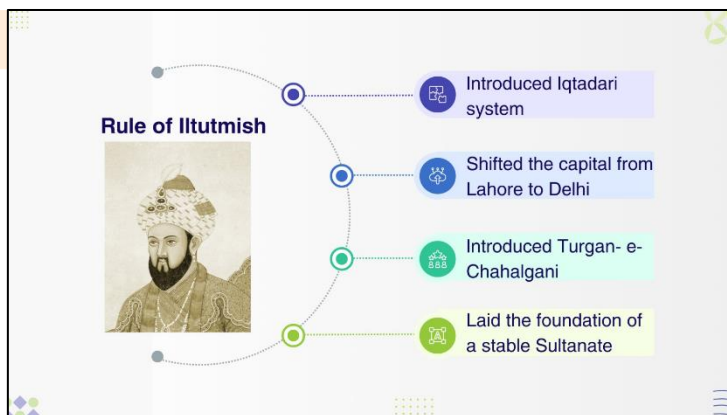


Slave Dynasty (1211-1236 AD):

- ❖ **Rule of Qutub-ud-Din Aibak:** After Ghor's death, Aibak declared himself as the Sultan of the region where he was employed as the **governor**. He ruled from **1206-1210**. This marked the beginning of the **Slave or Mamluk Dynasty**. The slaves were referred to as **Mamluk** in the Persian records.
 - Qutubuddin Aibak's rule saw the introduction of the **Policy of religious toleration**. He began with the construction of **Qutub Minar** but couldn't complete it and **died**. The name of Qutub has not been after the Sultan himself rather, it was built as a mark of respect for **Qutubuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki** who was a **Sufi saint**.
 - Aibak also constructed a mosque, **Arhai Din ka Jhopra** parallelly. It is believed that the entire structure of the mosque was constructed in two and a half days but it is somewhat an exaggeration. But, later it was interpreted that near the mosque, a fair was held for two and half days after which the mosque was named.
 - He was also called **Lakshbaksh** by his nobles as he would give big grants. He **died** while playing **Chaugan** (horse polo).
- ❖ **Rule of Aram Shah and Iltutmish:** After Aibak's death, the throne was ascended by **Aram Shah** who was Aibak's son. As his name suggests, he **loved leisure** and didn't turn out to be a good ruler as he could sit on the throne only for a year. So his **position** was taken over by **Iltutmish (1211-1236)**. Aram Shah was defeated in a battle by **Iltutmish**.
 - **Iltutmish** was considered to be the **real founder of the Slave Dynasty**. He was an early Delhi sultanate ruler who **consolidated and strengthened** the empire. He successfully **navigated succession challenges**, **quelled revolts**, and **asserted his authority**.



- It was **Ilututish** who shifted the capital from **Lahore to Delhi**. Ilututish's reign marked the establishment of a **stable monarchy**, with **significant achievements** in **administration, justice, and military expansion**.
- He introduced the **Iqta system**, which rewarded military officers with **land grants**, ensuring their loyalty. Ilututish continued the policies of **religious tolerance**, protecting the rights of non-Muslims.
- The revenue collected from the land allocated was sent to the Sultan's treasury and a part of it was paid as the **salary of Iqtadars**.
- However, Ilututish was well aware that he would not be able to have complete control over the **administration individually**. Owing to this crisis, he developed a system called **Turgan-e-Chahalgani**. It was a group of **40 nobles** who were very loyal to Ilututish.
 - ✓ These nobles attained **high positions in the empire**. It was because of these nobles that the empire became **consolidated and strong**.
- During this time, **Changiz Khan** was ruling over **Mongolia** and a large part of **central Asia**. His army was very efficient and any land that they would conquer would be destroyed and turned into a desert as the army engaged in **rampant killing, torturing, and plundering**.
- Ilututish too seemed to feel the **threat of the Mongol army** as **Changiz Khan** was steadily proceeding towards India.
 - ✓ **Changiz Khan** was not trying to defeat Ilututish rather he was following **Jalalludin Mangbarni**.



The latter tried taking **refuge in India** asking for asylum from Ilututish. But, Ilututish **did not entertain Mangbarni's plea** fearing the **rage of the Mongol army**.

- Before his death, Ilututish declared his **daughter, Razia Sultana** his **successor**. The notable architectural legacy of Ilututish includes the **Qutub Minar in Delhi**. His rule laid the **foundation for the stability and longevity** of the **Delhi Sultanate** in medieval India.

❖ **Reign of Razia Sultan (1236 – 1239 AD):**

- Sultan Iltutmish's daughter, Raziyya, became Sultan in 1236 AD and was a remarkable figure in the history of the Delhi Sultanate. She broke gender norms by becoming the first and only female ruler of Delhi.
- Raziyya was known for her intelligence, military prowess, and commitment to administrative reforms. Her reign faced opposition from conservative nobles, Ulema, who resisted a female ruler.
 - ✓ So, instead of Razia, the Ulemas placed one of Iltutmish's sons Ruknuddin Firuz on the throne. Another conflict was brewing in north west of India. So to subside the conflict, Sultan Ruknuddin Firuz left his army.
- In the meanwhile, Razia Sultan used his father's provision of the Bell of Justice as she felt that she was undergoing injustice. So, Razia wore red clothes and started ringing the bell. Whenever the bell rang, the Ulemas had to respond to their concern.
 - ✓ The Ulemas were shocked to see Razia asking to do justice to her. Seeing how a princess was powerful in front of the Ulemas, they saw it to be a good opportunity to dictate to her and place her on the throne just as a puppet Sultan of the Ulemas.
 - ✓ Thus, in 1236, Razia ascended the throne and became the only Muslim Sultan to have ruled over India.

- Other than Razia, Rudram Devi of the Kakatiya Dynasty ruled over the empire. Even in Kashmir, Queen Didda ruled over the empire and was affectionately referred to as 'didi' or 'elder sister' by her subjects.



- So, Razia was not the only female ruler to have ruled over India because before her, Queen Didda (a princess from the Lohara Dynasty who got married to

King Ksemagupta of Kashmir) ruled over Kashmir and after Razia, Queen Rudramdevi ruled over the Kakatiya dynasty.

- Contrary to what the Ulemas believed or wanted, she took the administration into her own hands and completely centralized it. She took the attire like a male Sultan, wearing Qaha and Kulha. She also started attending the court without a purdah. This was beyond the toleration of the Ulemas.
- Minhaj-i Siraj acknowledged her competence but felt uncomfortable with a female ruler. He believed that Razia sitting on the throne was against divine kingship and because of this, he stated that Razia was losing her qualities.
- An Ethiopian slave named Yakhut was given the status of Amir-e-Aakhur (Head of Royal Horses). Questions were raised as to how a slave could be made the head of an imperial section of the Delhi sultanate. A rumor was also spread that there was a love affair between Yakhut and Razia because of which he got the throne.
 - ✓ So the Ulemas started discussing how to dethrone Razia. Malik Altunia of Bhatinda, employed as a governor there, rebelled against Razia. To suppress Altunia, Razia left for Bhatinda to defeat the governor of Bhatinda.
 - However, Razia herself was defeated, captured, and put into jail. Acting smart, she offered Altunia a marriage alliance to dethrone another son of Iltutmish who was placed on the throne by the Ulema in her absence.
 - The marital offer was accepted by Altunia. An army was prepared with which both of them marched toward Delhi. But the Ulemas planned a secret attack on Razia and her new husband. She was attacked in a forested area and finally killed in 1240 AD.
- Despite her short rule, aimed to centralize power, improve administration, and promote religious tolerance. Raziyya's attempts at asserting authority faced many challenges, leading to her eventual dethronement and tragic end.
- Raziyya included her lineage as the daughter of Sultan Iltutmish on her inscriptions and coins. After Razia, many other rulers came to rule over the throne of the Delhi Sultanate like Bairam Shah but their rule was not very impactful.



Minhaj-i Siraj thought about Raziyya:

- ❖ Minhaj-i Siraj, a 13th-century Persian historian believed that Queen Raziyya's rule contradicted the ideal social order established by God.
- ❖ He questioned how she could possess excellent qualities when, according to him, women were meant to be subordinate to men.

❖ The period between 1246-1266:

- Nasir-ud-Din Mahmud, the youngest son of Iltutmish was placed on the throne during the period between 1246-1266. He was a religious person who spent his entire day copying the holy Quran and doing Sajdah.
 - ✓ So he did not have much interest in state affairs. So on his behalf, the Turgan-e Chahalgani took over the charge of the administration.
 - ✓ The head of Turgan-e Chahalgani then was Balban. Indirectly, Balban was ruling over the empire. Finally, after Nasir-ud-Din's death, he took over the throne.

Reign of Balban (1266-1287 AD):

- ❖ Once Balban came to power he understood that the position of Sultan was very weak. There was no law and order maintained in the empire along with the dominance of Turgan-e- Chalagani.
 - Parallelly, there was a continuous threat of the Mongols. There was no royal prestige and a lot of interference from amirs, along with weak administration, all of which led to Balban facing challenges upon ascending the throne. Thus, the era of Balban (1246-1287 AD) in the Delhi Sultanate was marked by strong authoritarian rule.
- ❖ Ghiyasuddin Balban, a former slave, established a powerful monarchy, made kingship a serious profession, and suppressed nobles' influence. He also looked into the decorum that had to be maintained in the royal court. He never laughed in his court neither did he allow any other noble to do so.

- ❖ Dancing, singing, and other activities of entertainment were **not allowed** in the court of Balban. Now with such strictness, the people of the Sultanate started **respecting the position of Sutan**.



- ❖ He also introduced the **practice of sajdah and paibos**. The term

'Sijadh' means the **practice of kneeling and touching the ground with the forehead** in salutation to the sultan. The term 'Paibos' means **kissing the feet of the king**.

- With this, he **uplifted the position** of the Sultan stating that the sultan was a **shadow of God**. He proclaimed himself to be **Jil-e-Ilahi** (representative of Allah). So, if one disrespects him, indirectly, that person would also **disrespect Allah**.

- ❖ To establish **political control**, he **reinstated the power of a Sultan over Turgan-e-Chahalgani** and **destroyed the entire system** fearing that another noble would come out of the system like him and **threaten the position of the Sultan**.

- ❖ To suppress his opponents, Balban introduced a **policy of blood and iron**, using ruthless tactics to maintain control. Balban implemented a **strict law-and-order regime**, including a **spy network** to curb dissent.

- ❖ His focus on **centralized authority and military strength** aimed to **restore stability**, but it also **intensified nobles' grievances**.

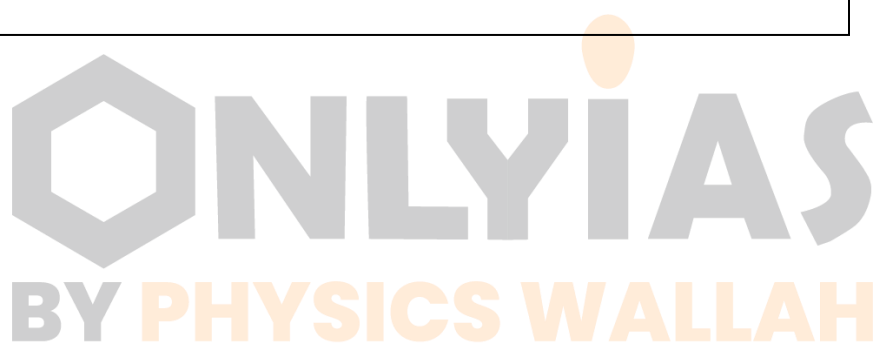
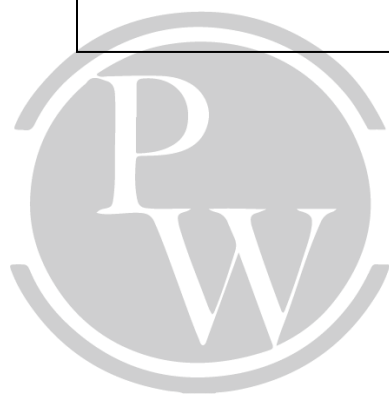
- He was **highly racial** as only the nobles from the higher caste were allowed to meet with him he was In hindsight, **Balban himself belonged to a lower caste**.

- Due to his **iron-fisted rule**, Balban's efforts laid the groundwork for a **more centralized and powerful sultanate**, influencing later rulers in medieval India.

- ❖ Being influenced by **Persian culture**, he also introduced the **Nouruz festival**. He named his sons **replicating the names of Persian kings like Qaikubad**. Kaimur, his son, took over shortly after. Around 1290 CE, Kaimur was killed and the throne was taken by **Feroz, the Ariz-e-Mumalik**. He founded the **Khalji dynasty** and assumed the name **Jalal-ud-din Khalji**.

Lecture -04

Delhi Sultanate (Part - II)



Delhi Sultanate (Part - II)



Outline of Lecture

- ❖ **Khalji of Khilji Dynasty (1290 AD - 1320 AD)**
 - **Alauddin Khalji (1296 AD - 1316 AD)**
 - **Internal Reforms by Alauddin Khilji**
- ❖ **The Tughlaqs (1320 AD - 1414 AD)**
 - **Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq (1320 AD - 1325 AD)**
 - **Muhammad Bin Tughluq (1325 AD - 1351 AD)**
 - **Firozshah Tughlaq (1351 AD - 1398 AD)**

Establishment of the Khalji of Khilji Dynasty (1290 AD - 1320 AD):

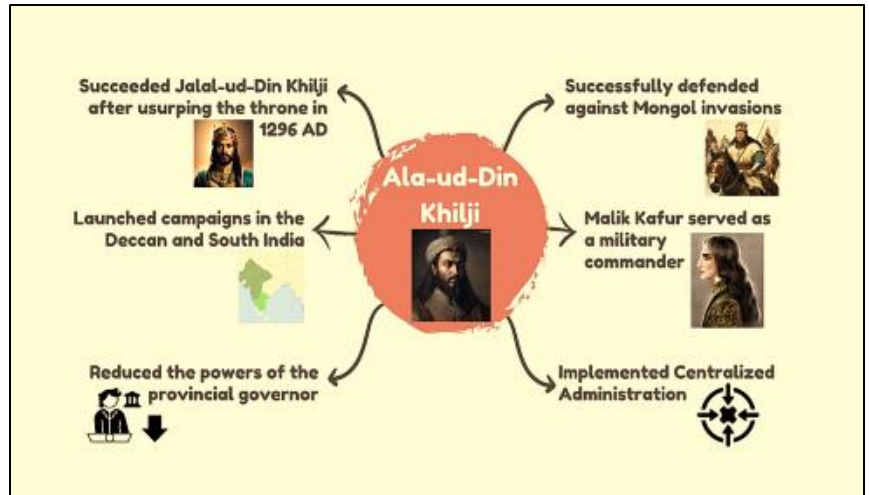
- ❖ After the death of Balban his grandson Muiz ud din Qaiqubad (17 years) became Sultan. After four years of incompetent rule, the Khalji rule began. The Khalji's were considered as non-Turks.
- ❖ Jalaluddin Khalji captured the throne of Delhi in 1290. This is called the Khalji Revolution (Jalaluddin Khalji led the Khilji Revolution). Jalaluddin Khilji was a very altruistic person. He was the founder of the Khilji Dynasty and a generous, lenient, and able administrator.
 - He made an effort to lessen the severity of Balban's reign. Being the first ruler of the Delhi Sultanate, he made it very evident what kind of government the people should support and that India could never be an Islamic state because the vast majority of its citizens were Hindu.
 - But, after Alauddin Khilji conquered Devagiri and accumulated wealth, he treacherously murdered his father-in-law Jalaluddin Khalji, and usurped the throne of Delhi in 1296 AD.

Alauddin Khalji (1296 AD - 1316 AD):

- ❖ Alauddin Khalji was Jalal-ud-din Khalji's nephew and son-in-law. During Jalaluddin Khalji's reign, he was appointed as both the Azizi-Mumalik and the Amir-i-Tuzuk and ruled for 20 years. Even though Alauddin was illiterate, he was an able soldier. He was

known for his military prowess and administrative reforms, expanding the Delhi Sultanate's territory.

- He successfully defended against Mongol invasions and launched campaigns in the Deccan and South India. His Army was very powerful because he was



given a regular salary in cash to his army. His reign also saw the introduction of market reforms like the 'controlled market' system and the strengthening of the agricultural sector.

- Alauddin's military achievements and efficient administration left a lasting impact on the Delhi Sultanate. He expanded the territory of the Delhi Sultanate to south India.
- Malik Kafur served as a military commander under the rule of Alauddin Khilji. He had indirect control of South India because of a lack of communication. He was an innovative & visionary person. He set up a highly centralized administration. He believes in potential, not in caste or race.

❖ Alauddin's steps to mitigate rebels:

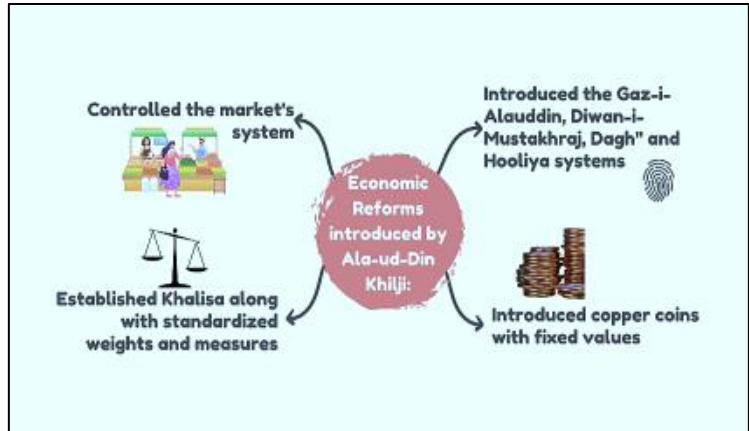
- He adopted a method with the most severity and ruthlessness.
- He created a strong spy network.
- Ban on social gatherings.
- He forbade banquets or Festivities.
- Marriage alliances among nobles were not allowed without his permission.
- Banned wines and intoxicants.

Internal Reforms by Alauddin Khilji:

- ❖ **Political Reforms:** Efficient and centralized state with a strong focus on military and economic stability, reduced provincial governor powers, and adopted a method of centralized administration.

❖ **Economic Reforms:**

- Alauddin Khalji Regulated the prices of essential goods to prevent inflation. He introduced the *Gaz-i-Alauddin* for land and revenue assessment. He also imposed taxes on agriculture and introduced the "Dagh" and Hooliya system.



- A system of measurement and assessment called the "diwan-i-mustakhraj" was established to ensure revenue collection and fund the army.
- He undertook the construction of forts, roads, and reservoirs and also introduced copper coins with fixed values. Along with this, he implemented strict measures against grain hoarding and established Khalisa (state-controlled granaries for a stable supply).
- He standardized weights and measures to ensure fair trade appointed government officials to conduct regular market inspections and imposed restrictions on gambling.

- ❖ Mubarak Shah succeeded his father Ala-ud-din Khalji and became the Sultan of the Khalji Dynasty in (1316-1320) AD. Mubarak Shah was an incompetent ruler so the governor of Punjab Ghazi Malik took the place of Mubarak Shah. It was this Governor of Punjab Ghazi Malik assumed the name Ghiyas-ud-din Tughluq at Delhi.

The Tughlaqs (1320 AD - 1414 AD):

- ❖ Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq (1320 AD - 1325 AD) established a new dynasty in 1320 AD which lasted till 1414. The Tughlaqs provided three competent rulers: Ghiyasuddin, his son Muhammad bin Tughlaq (1324-51 AD), and his nephew Firuz Shah Tughlaq (1351-88 AD). Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq reversed the rest of Alauddin Khalji's policies. Revenue tax decreased from 50% to 33% of total produce.
- ❖ The first two of these sultans ruled over an empire that comprised almost the entire country. The empire of Firuz was smaller but even then it was almost as large as that ruled over by Alauddin Khalji.

Reign of Muhammad Bin Tughluq (1325 AD - 1351 AD):

- ❖ Muhammad Tughluq's reign witnessed extensive administrative reforms, which proved to be costly and unpopular. He embarked on ambitious **military campaigns** but faced setbacks. His reign witnessed **administrative centralization** and **improved revenue collection**.

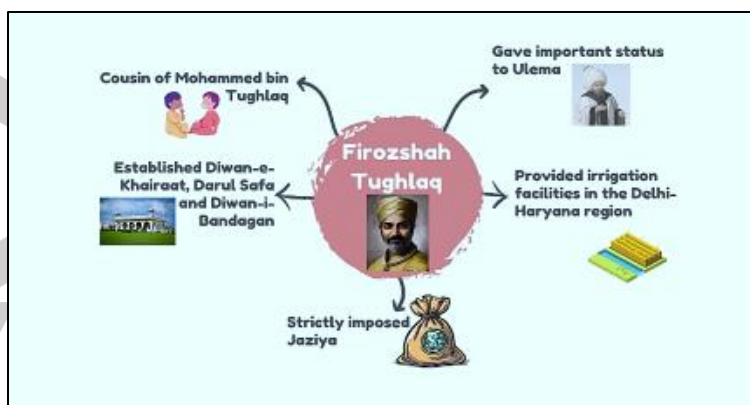
The infographic features a central portrait of Muhammad Bin Tughluq. Six arrows radiate from the portrait to various text boxes, each accompanied by a small icon:

 - Emphasized on merit, not caste, creed, or race** (Icon: Document with a star)
 - Scholar of mathematics, astronomy, astrology, and philosophy** (Icon: Graduation cap)
 - Introduced token currency and Doab-Takavi loan** (Icon: Gold coin)
 - Led expeditions to Khorasan, Transoxiana, and Karachi** (Icon: Map of Central Asia)
 - Transferred capital from Delhi to Daulatabad (1327 AD)** (Icon: Map of India showing the move from Delhi to the Deccan)
 - Extended the Sultanate's control to the Deccan and parts of South India** (Icon: Map of South India)
- Muhammad Tughluq's rule is marked by both innovation and turmoil, exemplifying the complexities of governance in medieval India. He issued taxation in the **Doab-Takavi loan** which was a **short-term loan** given to **poor farmers** to purchase seeds, fertilizers, and other **agricultural products** for greater production.
- Despite the challenges, he extended the **Sultanate's control to the Deccan and parts of South India**, leaving a legacy of administrative innovation and territorial expansion.
- ❖ Being the Sultan of Delhi during the 14th century AD, he is known for his ambitious and often controversial experiments and policies. He was the **most educated** yet most controversial Sultan. He established the **Pan India empire**, and he was a very **secular person**.
 - He was also called the **man of contradiction**, called a **conundrum** and **mad sultan**. He was a great scholar of mathematics, astronomy, astrology, and philosophy. He emphasized on merit, not caste, creed, or race.
 - But he was **hasty and short-tempered** and made decisions very quickly. Despite the challenges, he extended the Sultanate's control to the Deccan and the part of South India, and he left a legacy of administrative innovation and territorial expansion.
- ❖ **Muhammad Tughluq's ambitious Projects:**
 - **Transfer of Capital:** Muhammad Tughluq famously transferred the capital of the Delhi Sultanate from Delhi to Daulatabad in the Deccan in 1327 AD. This move was aimed at better administration of the southern regions but proved to be logistically challenging and unpopular.

- **Token Currency:** He introduced token currency made of copper and brass. The idea was to control the money supply and facilitate tax collection. However, economic chaos and a loss of confidence in the currency. It led to economic chaos and a loss of confidence in the currency
- **Expeditions:** He led the expedition of Khorasan and Transoxiana. He recruited a large army of 3,70,000 soldiers). Karachi (in Himachal) Expedition was a buffer zone between India and Tibet.
- ❖ Muhammad Tughluq's personality was distorted by Ziauddin Barni due to his fanatic mindset & Muhammad Bin Tughluq did not give him better patronage. It was on his death that Badauni (Historian) commented, "The king was freed from his people and they from their king".

Firozshah Tughlaq (1351 AD - 1398 AD):

- ❖ Firoz Tughluq was the son of Ghiyas-ud-din Tughluq's younger brother & cousin of Mohammed bin Tughlaq. He ruled for about 37 years & during a difficult period of the Sultanate.



- ❖ Firoz Shah Tughlaq made the Ulema a part of the political system. Quranic law to be guidelines for the state, and he was the first sultan to apply Jaziya to Brahmins.
- He attacked Hindu temples like Jwala Devi in Himachal even though it is believed that he was born to a Hindu woman, but he wanted to show himself as an orthodox Muslim person.
- ❖ Firozshah Tughlaq established a separate department, Diwan-e-Khairaat, an employment Bureau, old age pension food facilities free of cost to poor people, a hospital called Darul Safa, a slave department Diwan-i-Bandagan (Education to slaves).
- ❖ He built masjids, palaces, inns, ponds, canals, bridges etc. Established many schools and colleges. He provided arrangements for irrigation in the Delhi-Haryana region. He decreased land revenue.

- ❖ *Firoz Shah died in 1388 AD. After the death of Firuz, the Delhi Sultanate disintegrated and north India was divided into a series of small states and was finally overthrown by the Sayyid Dynasty. The invasion of Delhi by Timur in 1398 AD may be said to mark the end of the Tughlaq empire.*



Lecture -05

Delhi Sultanate (Part - III)



Delhi Sultanate (Part - III)



Outline of Lecture

- ❖ The Sayyid Dynasty (1414-1451 A.D.)
- ❖ Lodi Dynasty (1451-1526 A.D.)
- ❖ Administration during the Sultanate Period
 - Central Administration
 - Provincial and Local Administration
- ❖ Society under the Sultanate

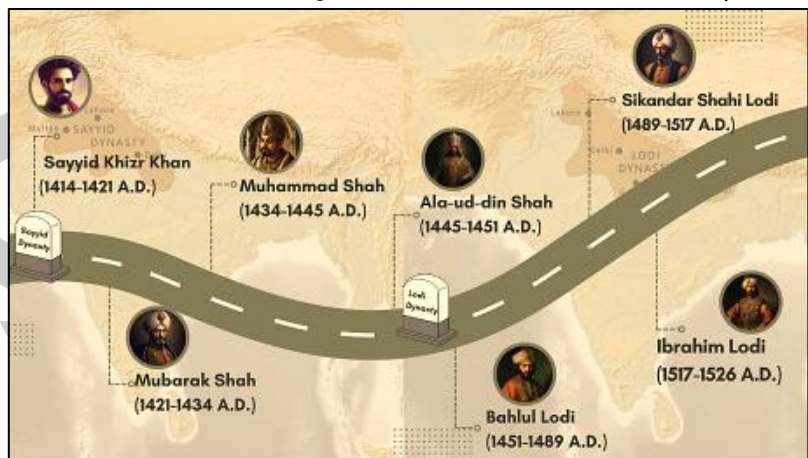
The Sayyid Dynasty (1414-1451 A.D.):

- ❖ Sayyid Khizr Khan (1414-1421 A.D.): He was the founder of the Sayyid Dynasty but did not swear any royal title. It is very interesting to note how he became the **Governor of Multan**. Timur invaded Hindustan in 1398.
 - In his attack, he captured the North-Western part of India. When he was returning, he placed a governor on his behalf to look after the territories captured. Multan presently is a part of Pakistan's Punjab province.
 - Khizr Khan took advantage of the **disordered situation and political instability** in the north-western part of India towards the end of the Tughlaq rule and the **return of Timur** back to Central Asia.
 - ✓ Thus in 1414 A.D., he occupied the **throne of Delhi** but died in 1421. He was not able to expand the empire to a very large extent.
- ❖ Mubarak Shah (1421-1434 A.D.): Mubarak Shah, Khizr Khan's son succeeded him. He tried consolidating the empire he inherited from his father. It is believed that he was the **first Sultan ruler to appoint Hindu nobles in the court of Delhi** to be a part of the administration.
- ❖ Muhammad Shah (1434-1445 A.D.): Muhammad Shah was Mubarak's nephew who succeeded him. He was **not** a very competent ruler as the system of administration under him was very weak.
 - Despite a **weak administration**, he was successful in **defeating the ruler of Malwa** and captured the territory with the help of **Bahlul Lodi**, the Governor of Lahore.

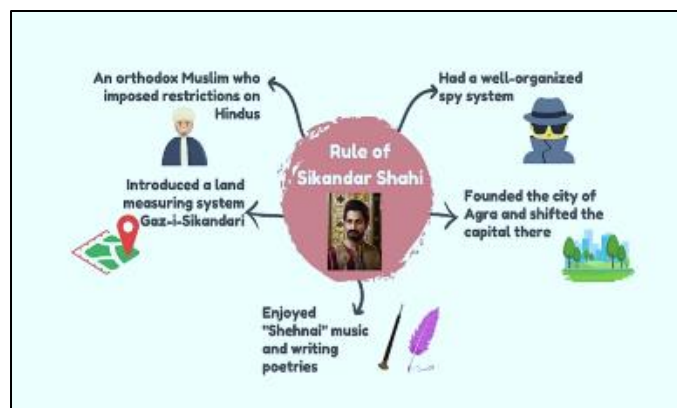
- ❖ **Ala-ud-din Shah (1445-1451 A.D.):** He was a very weak ruler who was not interested in administration. Thus, he was removed from the throne by Bahlul Lodi in 1451 A.D. Owing to his disinterest, Bahlul Lodi requested Ala-ud-din Shah to allow him to sit on the throne.
 - So the latter voluntarily descended from the throne for the former. Ala-ud-din Shah retired with all the existing royal privileges, thus marking the beginning of the Lodi Dynasty and the end of the Sayyids.

Lodi Dynasty (1451-1526 A.D.):

- ❖ **Rule of Bahlul Lodi (1451-1489 A.D.):** He was a wise Afghan statesman. So Lodhis were the first of the Afghan dynasties to have ruled over Hindustan. He was aware of his weak position and knew his limits owing to his Afghan race.
 - Before Bahlul, it was the Turks who ruled throughout. So, the nobility comprised nobles mostly of Turkish origin. Over that, he got the throne from the Sayyids so it is very obvious that the Sayyid nobility would have had the desire to take over the throne after Ala-ud-Din Shah's retirement.
- To scrape off the challenge, he tried yielding good relations with the Turkish nobles by taking various measures to gratify his nobles. He gave equal status to these nobles and treated himself as a commander.

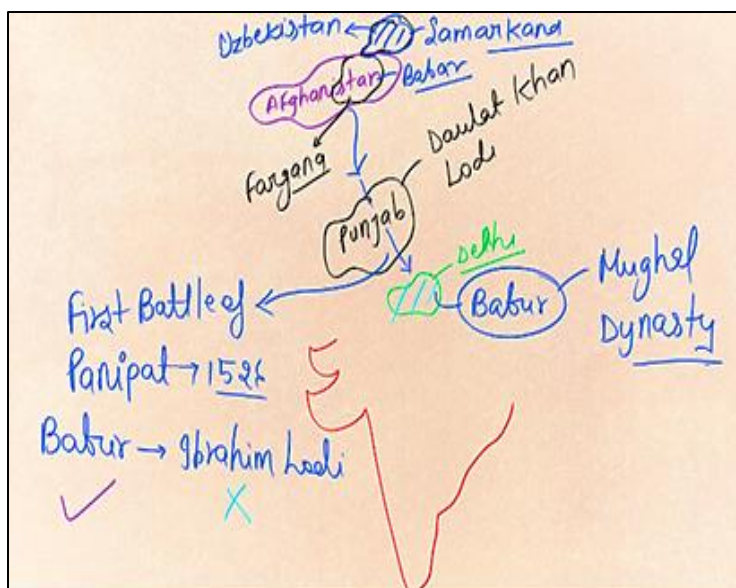


- ✓ To pacify his relations, he never tried exhorting the fact of him being a Sultan who was destined to be superior in comparison to these nobles.
- ✓ So, to gain support and recognition, Bahlul Lodi never sat on the throne instead, he



opted to sit on the carpet with his nobles. This action of his got him the support of not only the nobles but also the Ulemas. Finally, he died in 1489 A.D.

- ❖ **Rule of Sikandar Shahi (1489–1517 A.D.):** He was the son of Bahlul Lodi but his way of administration was different from that of his father. He was an orthodox Muslim which led to the imposition of restrictions on Hindus.
 - All of these actions led to the weakening of his governance. However, he had a well-organized spy system which helped in get a grip on the weakening administration.
 - He developed agriculture and industry which boosted the economy to a large extent. Sikandar Lodhi introduced a land measuring system Gaz-i-Sikandari. 1 Gaz-i-Sikandari = 32 inches.
 - He put severe restrictions on the Hindus along with vandalizing temples. It was Sikandar Shahi who not only founded the city of Agra but also shifted his capital there.
 - He also enjoyed "Shehnai" music and also spent time writing poetries. Even after his administrative attempts, he was unable to maintain a healthy relationship with his subjects owing to his atrocious religious policies. So, unlike Bahlul Lodi, even though he aced in administration, he turned out to be an intolerant ruler.
- ❖ **Rule of Ibrahim Lodi and the End of Lodi Dynasty (1517–1526 A.D.):** Sikandar Lodi was succeeded by Ibrahim Lodi. He was a stubborn and intolerant ruler who had no control over the administration. He even ill-treated his son Dilwar Khan Lodi.
 - Nobles were killed cruelly and many were humiliated by Ibrahim Lodi. This caused resentment in the Ulemas and also the nobles. At the same time Daulat Khan was a very powerful governor from Punjab who was very dissatisfied with Ibrahim's way of functioning.



- In Afghanistan's Fargana province, Babur had his rule. He was continuously conflicting with the Uzbek tribes of the Samarkand region (present-day Uzbekistan) to expand northwards.
 - ✓ After incessant defeats, he finally decided to expand southwards towards the Indian subcontinent. Now to enter Hindustan, Babur first had to cross through Punjab where Daulat Khan was governing.
- Ibrahim never understood the importance of Punjab owing to its locational advantage which would have helped in restricting the occupation of the North-west frontier region by other empires. So, angered by Ibrahim's actions, Daulat Khan invited Babur to invade India and take over the throne of Delhi.
 - ✓ Thus, in the First Battle of Panipat in the year 1526 A.D. Ibrahim Lodi faced defeat at the hands of Babur, thus leading to the establishment of Mughal rule in Hindustan.

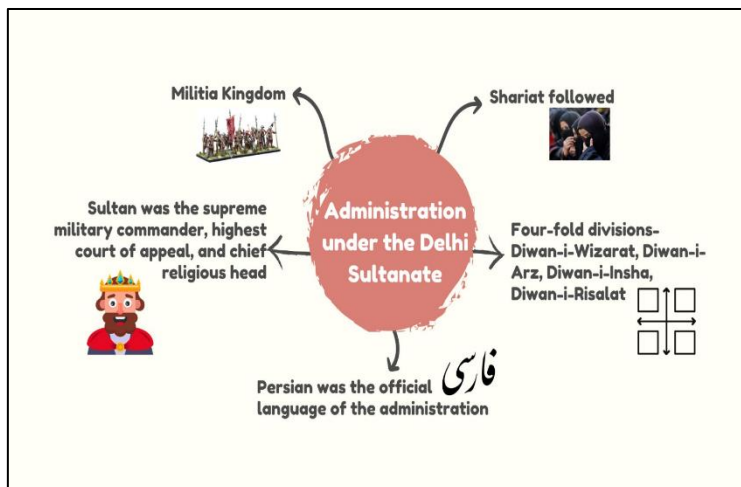
Administration during the Sultanate Period:

- ❖ **Supreme Position of the Sultan:** The Sultan was the center of power or the supreme authority in the Delhi Sultanate. To strengthen or showcase his powerful position, Sultans used titles like "Sikandar-i-Sani" (Second Alexander - Alauddin Khilji) and "Zil-e-Ilahi" (Shadow of God).
 - It was also stated that the Sultan had the divine right to rule. He was the supreme military commander, the highest court of appeal, and the chief religious head which made muftis, and ulemas to function under the Sultan.
 - Islamic law (Sharia) was implemented by the Sultan. The Qazis (Islamic judges) too were appointed by the Sultan to ensure fair trials. All of this made him Sarve Sarva.
- ❖ **Administrative Structure:** Early Delhi Sultans, particularly Iltutmish, preferred appointing special slaves known as 'bandagan' in Persian for key roles. Diwans were the medieval departments or ministries of the government.
 - **Divisions of Administration:** There were four-fold divisions (departments) in the administrative structure - Diwan-i-Wizarat (revenue department), Diwan-i-Arz (military department), Diwan-i-Insha (correspondence department), and Diwan-i-Risalat (department of religious affairs and the department of welfare affairs).

Diwan-i-Arz was first established by Balban as he remained threatened by the Mongol attack.

❖ **Central Administration:**

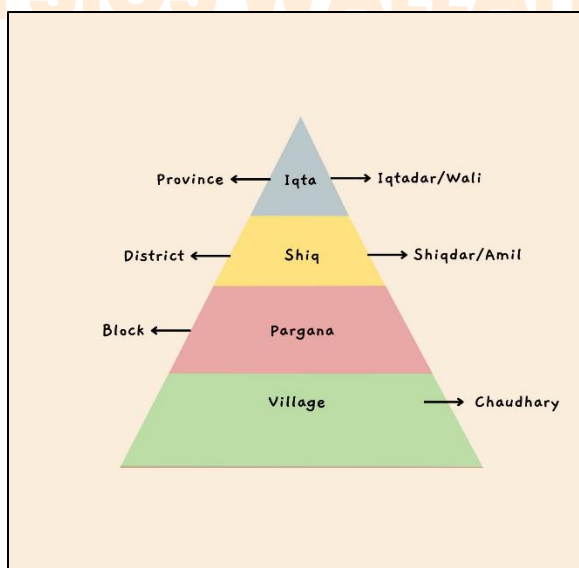
- **Military Administration:** The military administration was vital for maintaining the empire's control. The Sultanate was a militia kingdom. There were military commanders. Their efficiency kept the empire intact and strong. In most of



the scenarios, the Sultan was the head of the entire military. Ariz-i-Mumalik oversaw the army.

- **Monetary Administration:** Silver Tanka and copper Jital were widely used as a basic form of coinage during the Sultanate period.
- **Language and Culture of Administration:** Persian was the official language of administration during the Delhi Sultanate. Persian art and culture had a significant influence on the administration.
- **Communication and Correspondence:** The Diwan-i-Insha managed communication between the central administration and regional officials.

- ❖ **Provincial and Local Administration:** Under provincial administration, the entire Sultanate was divided into several Iqtas or provinces. The Iqtas were administered by a provincial governor known as Iqtadars or walis.



- The Military Commanders worked in association with the Iqtadars to look into the administration of the entire province.

✓ These commanders acted as Governors (Muqtis). Districts (shiq administration) were present below the provinces.

- ✓ Khalji and Tughluq monarchs followed the tradition of appointing military commanders as governors (muqtis) of various territories known as iqta.
- ✓ Officials who looked into the administration and maintenance of law and order in the state of the districts or shiqs were known as "shiqdars." Below the shiqdars, amils were present to manage revenue administration.
- The Block structure below the districts is occasionally found throughout the Sultanate period. The blocks were termed as Parganas.
- At the end of the level of administration, blocks were further divided into villages which were headed by the Chaudharies. These officials were looked into law enforcement, and maintaining order at the local level. Villages were self-sufficient and autonomous.
- ❖ Revenue System: The Iqta system continued where revenue-generating territories were granted to military commanders in exchange for military service. Iqta was an area or a piece of land.
 - The officials looked after maintaining law and order in their respective estates. A part of the revenue collected was paid as tribute to the Sultans. Thus, the tribute was a form of revenue that the Sultan got from the Iqtadars.
 - The Sultans also had khalisa land at their disposal from which the entire amount collected as revenue went to the royal treasury.
 - Also with revenue, taxes including the Khams and Kharaj were implemented. The amount collected through the imposition of taxes also acted as a source of revenue for the Sultan.

Facts to Remember:

- ❖ Kharaj: Land tax which was equal to one-tenth of the produce of the land.
- ❖ Zakat: Two and a half percent tax on property realized by Muslims.
- ❖ Kham: One-fifth of the booty captured (four-fifths was left for the soldiers).

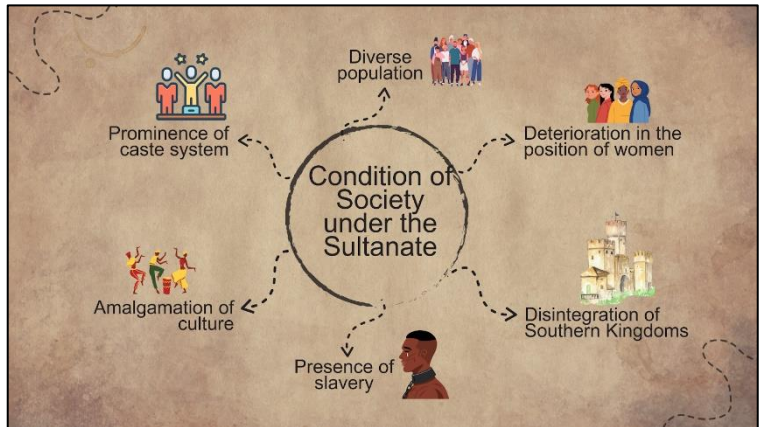
Society under the Sultanate:

- ❖ The population was very diverse as in nobles, artisans, traders, farmers, peasants, and merchants, all of these groups constituted an integral part of the economy. Along with religious diversity, the caste system was very prominent during the Sultanate period.



Slavery was a prominent feature of this period. African slaves were imported from the Abbisynian region of Ethiopia.

- ❖ The position of women was very problematic. The purdah system was prevalent along with the evil practice of sati pratha.
- ❖ Because of the widespread use of Persian as an official medium of exchange, it amalgamated with the native culture of Hindustan.
- ❖ In the field of education, Madrasas were set up. Only the traditional form of education was imparted. It was during this period that Sufi and the Bhakti movement had a prominent impact on society.
- ❖ During the same period in the south of India, the Bahamani and the Vijayanagara empire disintegrated into two separate kingdoms.



Lecture -06

Mughal Period



Mughal Period



Outline of Lecture

- ❖ Background to the Mughals and the Coming in of Babur
- ❖ Reign of Babur
- ❖ Reign of Humayun
- ❖ Reign of Akbar
- ❖ Mughal Administrative Setup

Background to the Mughals and the Coming of Babur:

- ❖ The Mughal rule began in Bharat with the coming of Babur. He had the lineage of both the Turks and the Mongols because his mother Qutlugh Nigar Khanum was a Mongol lady, hailing from the family of Changiz Khan and his father Umar Sheikh Mirza was a Turk by origin and belonged to the family of Timur. This resembles how strong the dynastic line he had. However, Babur himself preferred to be known by his Turkish origin.
- ❖ It is already known that he faced defeats from the Uzbek tribes (who belonged to Samarkand, part of Transoxiana) which finally made him shift his focus and expand southwards. Babur first started by taking over Kabul and Kandahar.

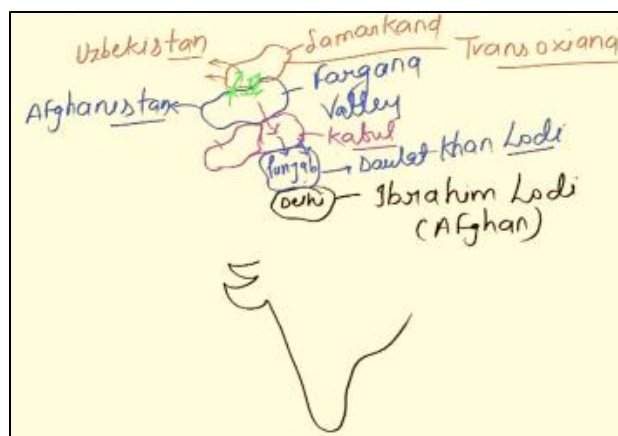


- The distance between Kabul and Punjab being less, it was easily scaled by Babur upon Dulat Khan Lodi's invite.
- Rana Sangha invited Babur to topple the throne owing to his belief that Babur too would turn out to be like other invaders who would loot India's riches and create a power vacuum upon their departure. Rana Sangha assumed that in this power vacuum, he would take over the throne of Delhi.

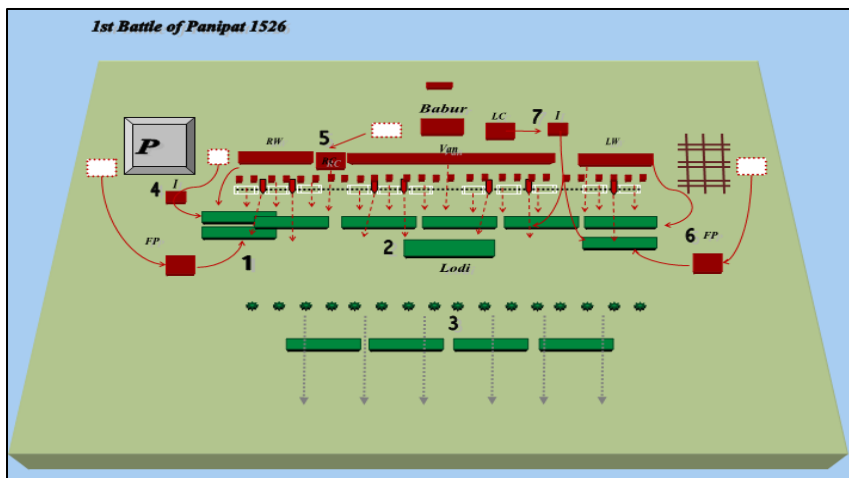
❖ Babur met Ibrahim Lodi at Panipat (in Haryana) and the First Battle of Panipat was fought. In the battle, Ibrahim Lodi had a huge army comprising of one lakh soldiers along with elephants whereas Babur had an army of about 15000-18000 soldiers.



- Gunpowder or barud was already found before 1526. However, the Mughals were not the first dynasties to have used Gunpowder in wars as the Bahamani kingdom already had utilized barud in their warfare (not used in canons but as explosives).
- What made Babur win the war was the use of canons loaded with gunpowder. Canon was not commonly used during that time.
- Even though Ibrahim Lodi thought that Babur would not be able to carry those humongous canons from Fargana Valley to Panipat, Babur did the unexpected as he tied canons on the backs of camels. Even the arrows Babur's army used had a bigger range, unlike Ibrahim's army.



- ❖ Babur used the Tulguma technique which he had learnt from the Uzbeks. In this technique, the whole army was divided into various units, viz. the Left, the Right, and the Centre. The left and right divisions were further subdivided into

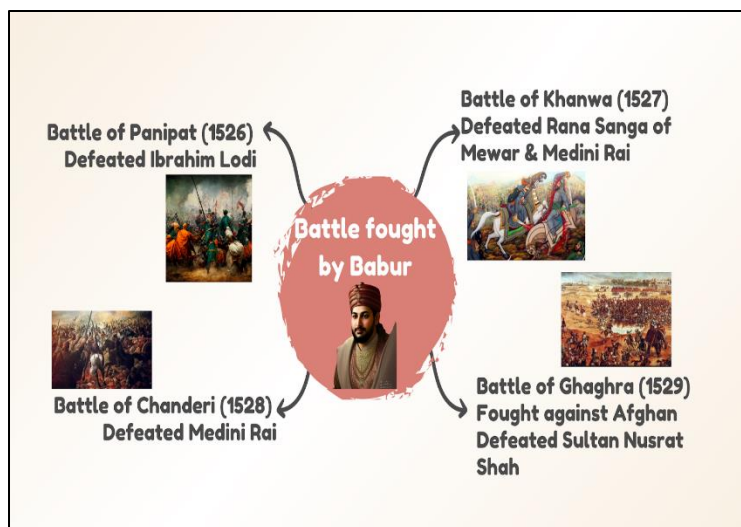


Forward and Rear divisions. Through this, a small army could surround the enemy from all sides.

- The first line consisted of the archers on horseback. Just behind the line, there were bullock carts that had canons fitted on them.
- After firing the canons, the frontline soldiers would come forward and fight. In the second line of soldiers, Babur was positioned. In this line, two mobile wings were used to encircle the army of the enemy.
- When the elephants heard the sound of the cannon firing they ran backward frightened and in the commotion, Ibrahim Lodi's soldiers were killed.
- When the mobile wings encircled Lodi's army, Ibrahim was killed. Thus bringing Babur's first victory in the Indian subcontinent.

Reign of Babur:

- ❖ Babur fought four wars, the first being the Battle of Panipat (1526). Post that he fought the Battle of Khanwa (1527) where Mewar's Rana Sangha was defeated. Sangha who had promised to help Babur in the Battle of Panipat did not do so.



- Also, as per Sangha's idea that Babur would loot India and return to Fragana, it did not happen. This angered Sangha as his dream to sit on the throne remained a dream.
 - ✓ So, Sangha was helped by **Medinirai (Chanderi King)** in the battle. Babur gave a religious tone to the Battle of Khanwa. He promised to give up drinking alcohol if they turned out to be victorious in the war.
- In 1528, Babur fought against Medinirai and defeated him in the Battle of Chanderi. He did not have any personal grudge against Medinirai other than he had helped Sangha in the war of Khanwa.
- Finally, in 1529, he fought against the Afghans in the Battle of Ghaghra. Bengal's Sultan Nusrat Shah too was defeated in this battle.
- ❖ Babur died from an unknown illness at Agra in 1530 CE. He was initially buried in Agra, but years later, was reburied in Kabul according to his wishes. He was succeeded by Humayun, Babur's eldest son. He advised him to bring up his children with love and care even if they didn't deserve it and forgive his brothers who would do wrong to him.

Reign of Humayun:

- ❖ He was completely the opposite of ruthless and over-ambitious Babur as by nature Humayun was very soft and not very capable as a ruler. He had four brothers. During this period two laws of succession were seen:
 - The law of primogeniture which was very popular among the Hindu kings. In this, the eldest son would naturally inherit his father's throne.
 - The other law of succession was Copercenary. In this method, the empire was divided among all the brothers and was a popular practice among the Turks, unlike the Ottomans where the practice of fratricide (killing of brothers) was prevalent. This practice was similar to the practice of primogeniture undertaken by the Hindu kings.
- ❖ Humayun was followed by Askari, Hindal and Kamran. They also had a sister, Gulrukh Begum who authored Humayunama. Among all the brothers Kamran created a lot of tension. Humayun adhered to his father's wishes to divide the empire among his siblings.

- Kamran was given to rule over Kabul and Kandahar, Hindal got Rajasthan, Delhi, and the adjoining area was kept by Humayun and the area of Sambhal in Uttar Pradesh was given to Askari.

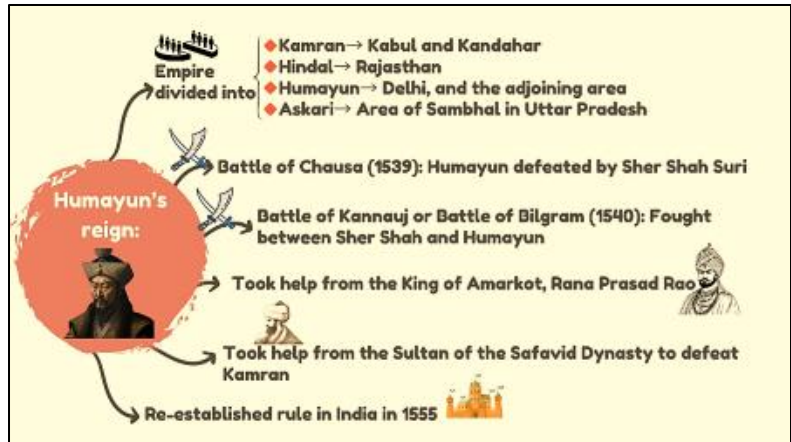


- ❖ The Safavid Dynasty was ruling over Iran during this period.

Kandahar and Kabul were on the boundaries of the Safavid dynasty. There was a persistent threat from the Afghans.

- Sher Shah Suri who was an Afghan chief fought a war against Humayun in 1533, however, no result came out of the war and a treaty was signed.
 - ✓ But Suri always had an eye on the central throne owing to the Mughals being invaders who forcibly took over the throne. Finally, in the Battle of Chausa (1539), Humayun was defeated at the hands of Sher Shah Suri.
- ❖ Post his defeat, he gave a call to all his brothers to fight as a union against Sher Shah to consolidate their empire. Apart from Kamran, the other two brothers extended their support. Kamran advised Humayun to directly set an attack on Sher Shah Suri. but this idea was not acceptable to Humayun because he had already faced the blow.
- Because of differences in their opinions, Kamran refrained from supporting his brother. The Battle of Kannauj took place at Kannauj, Uttar Pradesh, India between Sher Shah Suri and Humayun in 1540. This battle is also known as the Battle of Bilgram, where Humayun was defeated.
- For fifteen years, he remained in exile whereas the Sur dynasty was flourishing in the Delhi and Ajmer regions of India. However, Humayun did not give up.
- ❖ Even though Humayun requested Sher Shah Suri to let him be in Punjab, he refused to do so and asked him to leave for Kabul and Kandahar. As Humayun began progressing towards Kabul, Kamran saw this as a threat and attacked Humayun.

- In the meanwhile, Humayun who had gotten married to Hamida Banu Begum was pregnant with Akbar. Being unable to flee for long, he took help from the King of Amarkot, Rana Prasad Rao (Hindu Rajput ruler).



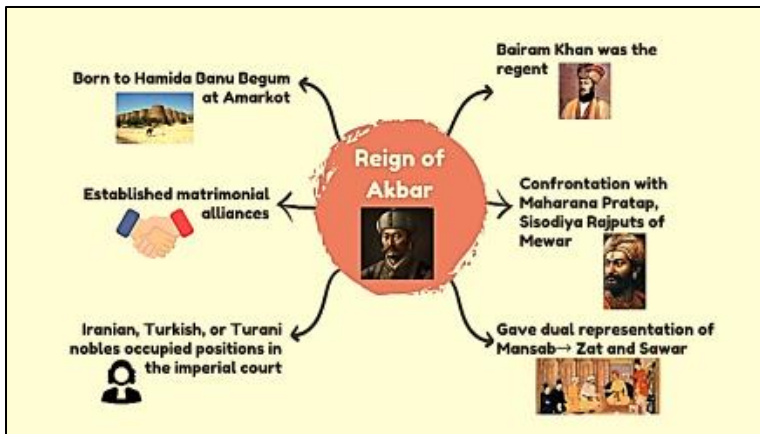
- ❖ Post Akbar's birth, Humayun left for the Safavid dynasty where he was given a grand welcome. The Safavids wanted to gain control over the region under Kamran's jurisdiction for a very long period. The grand welcome that was given to Humayun raised tensions in Kamran.
 - He tabled a proposal in front of the Safavids asking to give him Humayun alive or dead in return for the entire region of Kandahar.
 - Fortunately, the Sultan of the Safavid Dynasty did not accept Kamran's proposal and welcomed Humayun wholeheartedly. The Sultan gave his army to Humayun to fight against Kamran. After being defeated, Kamran fled but was later captured and his eyes were damaged. Kamran died on his way to Hajj.
- ❖ In the meanwhile, the later rulers of the Sur dynasty were turning out to be very weak and incompetent. Finally, in 1555, Humayun attacked Delhi and established his rule over India all over again. After six months, he died in 1556 due to his fall from the staircase of his library.

Reign of Akbar:

- ❖ When Akbar was just 14 years old, he ascended the throne post his father's death. Bairam Khan became Akbar's regent and ruled the empire on Akbar's behalf. When Akbar himself took over the charges, he established good relations with the Rajputs to ensure an efficient system of administration.
 - He established matrimonial alliances with the Rajputs. But the Sisodiya Rajputs of Mewar refused to accept Akbar's sovereignty which led to a bitter confrontation between Maharana Pratap and Akbar.



- Even though Akbar was successful in capturing Chittor from Rana Pratap initially, in the later stage, Rana Pratap recaptured the entire Mewar.
- The Rajputs extended their support to the Mughal empire through their services. Man Singh was a famous military commander whereas Todar Mal was a financial expert.



Technically Akbar's battle with Rana Pratap was fought by Man Singh.

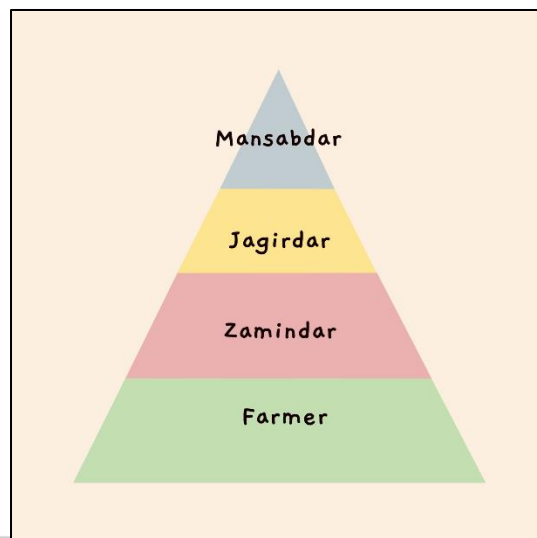
- ❖ Akbar biography, Akbarnama was authored by Abul Fazl. The biography has three volumes. The first volume talks about Akbar's ancestry, and the second volume talks extensively about the period of Akbar's reign. Finally in the third volume (Ain--i-Akbari), we get a lot of statistical data about Akbar's rule.
- ❖ The Mansabdari system was introduced by Akbar in 1571. The word 'Mansab' means position or rank. Under Akbar's administration, the Iranian nobles occupied a dominant position in the nobility because Humayun had a good relationship with the Safavids of Iran.
- Even the Turkish or Turani nobles occupied a large percentage of higher positions in his court.
- Now, to give specific positions to these nobles mansabdari system was introduced. The system had three elements - Rank, Salary, and responsibility. There was a dual representation of Mansab.
 - ✓ **Zat:** This indicated the rank in the administration as well as the salary of the Mansabdar.
 - ✓ **Sawar:** This represented the cavalry rank. It denotes the number of horses and cavalymen maintained by Sawar.
- The salary was decided based on their rank. These mansabdars were also responsible for maintaining the army and horses.
 - ✓ Those Mansabdars who were paid through land (Jagirs) were called Jagirdars.

- ✓ The capital to maintain the expenses of the army and horses was obtained from the revenue collected from the jagirs (land). Now, one portion of the revenue collected was also paid as a tribute to the emperor.

➤ **Understanding Mansabdars, Jagirdars, and Zamindars:**

- ✓ **Mansabdars:** The Mansabdars were allotted jagirs to meet their expenses. So, in this way, a mansabdar would also become a jagirdar.

- ✓ **Jagirdars:** Not all nobles were mansabdars but only jagirdars. In this system, the nobles were allotted separate pieces of land. A portion of the amount collected as revenue from their jagirs was paid as a tribute to the emperor.



- ✓ **Zamindars:** They came under the Jagirdars and Mansabdars. Farmers came under the authority of zamindars from whom revenue was forcibly collected and then given to the jagirdars and mansabdars.

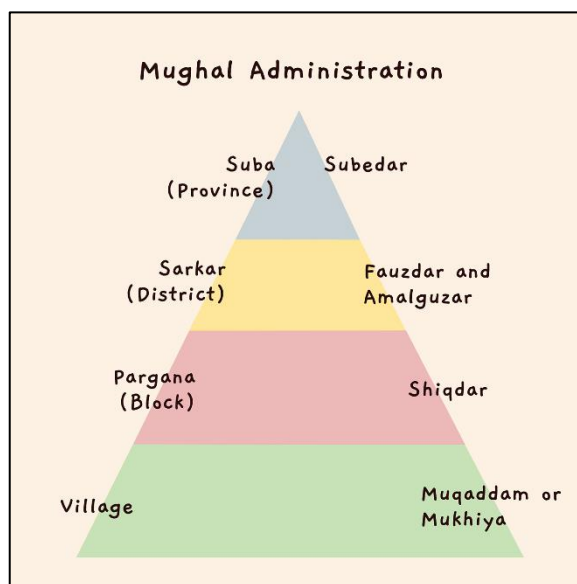
- ❖ The position of muqti from the Sultanate period required them to stay in one particular location (provinces allotted to them). However, this was not a necessary criterion for the mansabdars.

- They could be transferred from one section of the administration to another section, for example from military to civil or vice versa. So, their presence in the provinces was not very important.
- **Example:** Man Singh who had the rank of 5000 mansab never strayed in his province but fought battles and was mostly present in the imperial durbar.

Mughal Administrative Setup:

- ❖ The entire Mughal empire was divided into multiple subahs. It was to responsibility of the subahdar to administer the subahs (province). Below the subahs were the sarkars (district) and the responsibility to administer these sarkars was vested in the Faujdar and Amalguzar.

- The *faujdar* looked into the maintenance of law and order whereas *Alamgazar* looked into revenue assessment and collection. Below *sarkars* were the *Parganas* or blocks.
- *Shiqdar* (executive officer) was vested with the responsibility to administer the *Parganas*. Below the blocks were the villages which were headed by *Muqaddam* or village headman or *Mukhiya*.

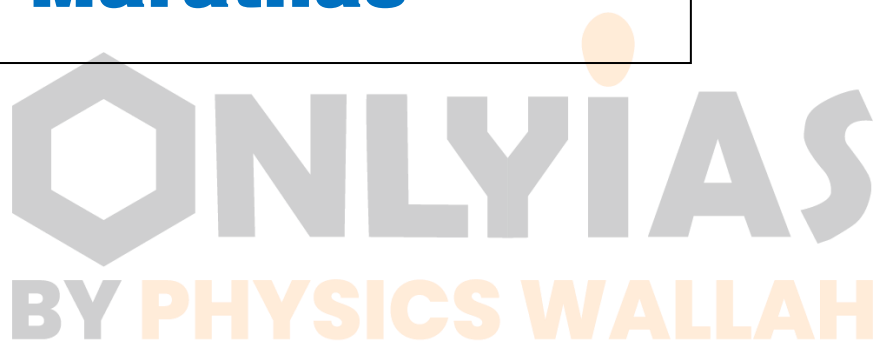
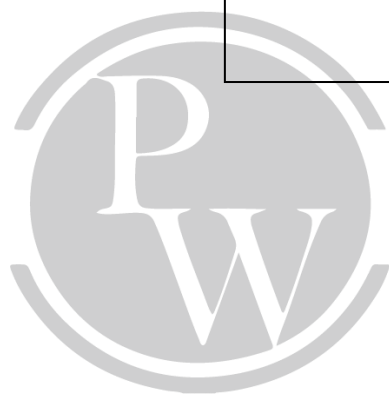


- ❖ **Zabti System:** The land revenue during Akbar's period was based on an assessment of lands and the different amount was taken from different lands. This system of land assessment in taking revenue was called *Zabt*. The system was designed by Raja Todarmal between 1570 and 1580.

Changes in the Mughal Empire during the 16th Century:

- ❖ Economic disparity along with the rise of an elite class was highly noticeable during this century. Only 445 mansabdars (5-56% of the total number of mansabdars) held 61% of the total revenue estimated. This resulted in decreasing profits for the farmers. So the rich became richer and the poor became poorer.
- ❖ In terms of an elite class, the *Iranis* and *Turanis* possessed substantial power. *Hyderabad* and *Oudh* saw an extensive increase in elites or nobles.

Lecture -07
Marathas



Marathas



Outline of Lecture

- ❖ Mughal Rule through the Eyes of the Traveller
- ❖ Rise of the Marathas
 - Factors Responsible for the Rise of Marathas
 - About Shivaji Maharaj (1630-1680 AD)
 - Administration of the Marathas
 - ✓ Central
 - ✓ Provincial
 - ✓ Financial

Mughal Rule through the Eyes of the Traveller:

- ❖ Jesuit Roberto Nobili who came from Portugal translated Indian texts into European languages. He used a novel method of adaptation to preach Christianity, adopting many local customs of India which were, in his view, not contrary to Christianity.
- ❖ Duarte Barbosa was a Portuguese writer, who provided a comprehensive account of trade and society in South India. After he arrived in Goa, Barbosa made the journey to Vijayanagara soon after. His account mentions the king of Narsyngua, who is probably Vira Narasimha Tuluva.
- ❖ Pelsaert was a Dutch traveler (presently from the Netherlands) who highlighted the extreme poverty of Hindustan's population. For this cause, he blamed the Mughal state, noting that peasants barely had enough to eat due to heavy taxation.
- ❖ Jean-Baptiste Tavernier was a famous French traveler, who made multiple journeys, focusing on India's trade. At Louis XIV's request, Tavernier penned *Les Six Voyages de Jean-Baptiste Tavernier*. He provides extensive information about diamonds and Indian diamond mines in his book.
- ❖ Manucci who was an Italian doctor chose to settle in India. He was employed in the services of the Mughal prince Dara Shikoh, who was eventually defeated by his brother

Aurangzeb. His travels and quests for employment took him from all over India – from Kashmir to Bengal, and Goa to Madras.

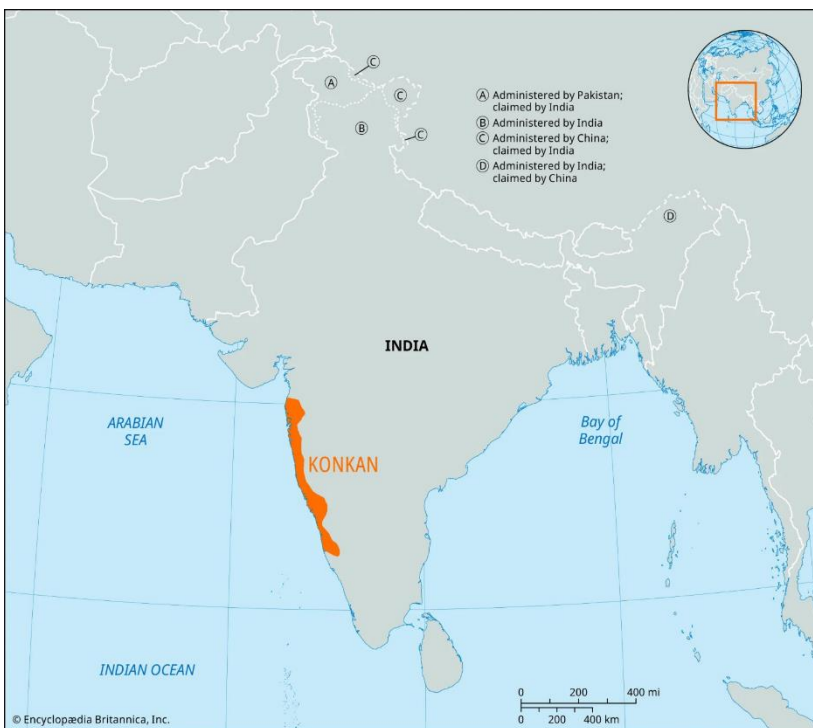
- ❖ **Francois Bernier** was a Frenchman who spent twelve years in the Mughal Empire. The accounts of Bernier talk about the condition of the economy and society during that phase.
 - **Francois Bernier's Account of India:** Bernier dedicated his major work to Louis XIV, the French king. He gave a detailed account of imperial karkhanas or workshops in which various artisans worked like embroiderers, goldsmiths, painters, lacquer workers, joiners, tailors, and shoemakers, as well as silk, brocade, and muslin manufacturers. He was surprised to see how the artisans worked from morning to evening routinely without aspiring for better opportunities in life.
 - ✓ He also highlighted the socio-religious conditions during that phase where it was noted that on one hand there was a wealthy ruling class and on the other end, there was a mass of impoverished people, with no significant middle class. He also witnessed an event of child sati in Lahore.
 - ✓ In terms of the economic conditions of that period, the population was engaged in manufacturing textiles, gold, silver, and more. India also played a role in the circulation of gold and silver globally.
 - Merchants of the West were similar to the Mahajans in the East who were involved in the money-lending business. He also stated that these merchants had tight-knit communities and in the urban areas, money lending was led by Nagar Sheth.

Rise of the Marathas:

- ❖ The Marathas rose from the Konkan region. Their journey towards the epitome started in Pune. Formally their reign started on 6th June 1674 when Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj was crowned. The term Chhatrapati meant 'supreme king.'
- Their reign continued and ended with the defeat of Peshwa Bajirao II (1818) at the hands of the British East India Company.

❖ The history of the Marathas historically starts with **Shahji Bhonsle** who was **Shivaji's father**. He was not a Raja but was a jagirdar of **Pune**.

- During his lifetime, he extended his services to **Jahangir, Shah Jahan, Sultans of Ahmednagar, and Bijapur**. He also had a confrontation with **Shah Jahan** upon the death of **Ahmadnagar's Sultan**.



- **Shahji Bhonsle** became the regent of the Sultan's infant son. This angered the Mughals that **Shahji Bhonsle** was exercising indirect control over **Ahmadnagar**. Upon the **Mughal** attack, the territory of **Ahmadnagar** came under their rule.

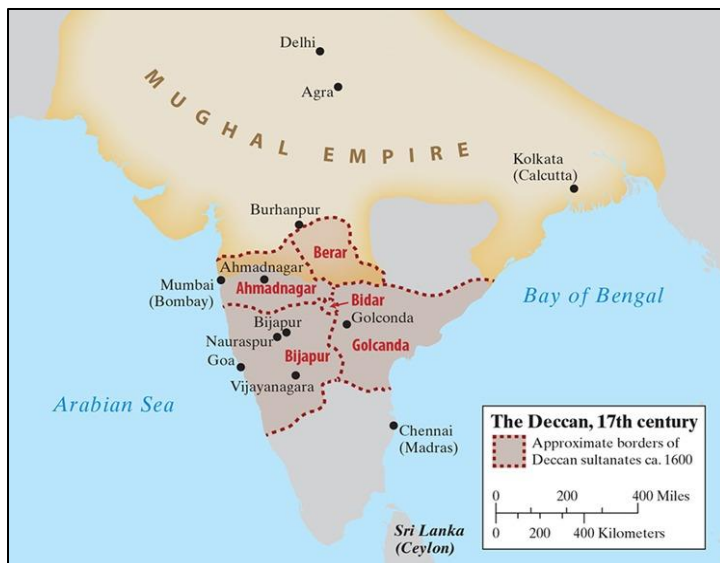
❖ Before the rise of the Marathas, the **Konkan** region was under the rule of the **Bahamani Kingdom**. During the same period, the extreme south of the Indian subcontinent was under the reign of the **Vijayanagara Empire**. **Krishnadeva Raya** who (ruled between 1509-1529) was an eminent king who hailed from this dynasty. His attack on the **Bahamani** kingdom was so disastrous that the entire empire disintegrated into five separate kingdoms: **Golkonda, Bijapur, Ahmednagar, Berar, and Bidar**. It was **Shahji Bhonsle** who remained a common individual between the **Mughal Durbar** placed in **Delhi** and the disintegrated kingdoms of **Bijapur** and **Ahmadnagar**.

❖ From his father, **Shivaji Maharaj** inherited the jagir of **Pune** around **1630**.

- Upon reaching a certain age, he started expanding his territory in the neighboring areas. This angered the Sultan of **Bijapur** because it was the territory of **Bijapur** which was being occupied by **Shivaji**. The **Mughals** too were angered by this expansionist tendency of **Shivaji Maharaj**.

Factors Responsible for the Rise of Marathas:

❖ **Geographical Location:** The Maratha region consisted of a narrow strip of land called Konkan which had precipitous mountains, inaccessible valleys, and impregnable hill-forts. This was favorable for military defense. The Marathas were very well acquainted with the rough terrain so only the Marathas were able to exercise their strong hold around the region of Konkan.



❖ **Military Prowess:** The Marathas had a long tradition of military prowess. They had earlier served under the Bahmani Sultans, the Sultans of Ahmadnagar, Bijapur, Golconda, Bidar, and Berar. They were excellent in "Guerrilla warfare" and were known for their mobility.

❖ **Impact of Bhakti Movement:** The hymns of the Bhakti saints were sung in Marathi which created a bond among people across the society. These saints stressed the principle of oneness. This brought about unity in the Maratha community leading to the strengthening of the empire.

❖ **Weakening of Mughals and Deccani Sultans:** The Marathas were united after the degeneration of Bijapur and Golconda. Also, the Deccan wars against the Sultans of Bijapur, Golconda, and Ahmednagar had exhausted the Mughal treasury. The later Mughals were unable to have a grip over any matter owing to their inefficiency.



- ❖ **Leadership by Shivaji Maharaj:** Shivaji who was a very strong and brave commander was adept at making strategies, he was aware of both strengths and weaknesses. He united the Marathas who were scattered in many parts of Deccan under his leadership and built a mighty kingdom, with Raigad as the capital.

About Shivaji Maharaj (1630-1680 AD):

- ❖ When he tried expanding his power, Shivaji had to encounter challenges
 - **From Bijapur and Mughals:** To expand his territories, Shivaji Maharaj confronted the Sultan of Bijapur upon occupying their territories. Multiple forts of Bijapur were captured. Even though there was conflict, a portion of the territory of Bijapur and the adjoining areas came under the control of Shivaji.
 - ✓ Now, Shivaji insisted on recognizing him as the jagirdar of the area he had occupied by letting him serve as the vassal of the Sultan of Bijapur. The Sultan did not have faith in Shivaji because he understood that the promise he made regarding the payment of tribute would go unheard of once he got what he desired. So after 1657, the confrontation grew further.
 - Aurangzeb too was serving as the Governor of Deccan during this period of tumult. Berar was brought under the Mughal control by Aurangzeb. Post that, he forced a peace treaty with Shivaji Maharaj and Bijapur. This infuriated Shivaji which then led to consistent attacks on the Mughal as well as territories of Bijapur.
 - To make Shivaji pay for his actions, the Sultan of Bijapur appointed Afzal Khan to capture Shivaji. Afzal Khan then attacked Pune and occupied a considerable portion of Pune.
 - ✓ When he failed at capturing Shivaji, a peace treaty was offered. In hindsight, Afzal Khan had sketched out a plan to assassinate Shivaji by calling him to a cordial meeting.
 - ✓ It is said that Shivaji served as the Hindu commander under Afzal Khan. This plan of his was informed to Shivaji by another Hindu commander. In some other accounts, this Hindu commander was replaced with Goddess Durga.
 - ✓ Shivaji Maharaj hatched his plan by placing his army in the forested regions (guerilla warfare) and took one archer and an individual with a sword along with him to meet Afzal Khan.

- ✓ Upon embracing each other, Afzal Khan stabbed Shivaji with a knife but it did not kill Shivaji because he being warned made him take necessary precautions.
 - Understanding his treachery, a war blew out between the army of Bijapur and the Marathas, and Afzal Khan was successfully killed with Shivaji's Baghnakh. This event dampened the morale of the Bijapur Sultan. Unwillingly, he recognized Shivaji's legitimacy and sovereignty.
- After Aurangzeb captured Berar, the Mughal empire lost their Badshah Shah Jahan. When he got to know about his father's death, a war of succession began between Aurangzeb and his brothers. To establish his legitimacy, Aurangzeb left for Delhi.
- ✓ This was when Shivaji thought to be a great opportunity and he attacked Surat in 1664. Surat acted as a major port for the Mughals in the Arabian Sea where his soldiers plundered the city completely.
- ✓ Shivaji Maharaj also imposed Chauth as an annual tribute on Surat.
- Shivaji for the longest time wanted to persuade Aurangzeb to recognize him as his vassal (jagirdar) of the Deccan region. But it went unheard and unnoticed until Shivaji attacked and captured Surat. By this time, the Marathas took control over 35 forts.
- Under Aurangzeb, Shahista Khan became the Governor of the Deccan. As Shivaji continued with his annexation policies, Shahista declared war on Shivaji and went on to win over the territories under the control of the Marathas.
- ✓ But, surprisingly 400 Maratha soldiers entered inside the camp set up by Shahista for a marriage function. The army from both sides confronted each other.
- ✓ Shahista Khan was attacked by Shivaji in which three of his fingers were cut. After the incident, he somehow fled and escaped to Delhi where Aurangzeb being angered with the situation asked him to leave for Bengal.
- To come to an understanding, Jai Singh I (Rajput ruler) was sent as Aurangzeb's consort to meet with Shivaji. In this meeting, the Treaty of Purandhar was signed. After the agreement, Shivaji agreed to surrender 23 forts which he had captured over the period, and keep the rest 12 forts with him.

- ✓ In return, Shivaji wanted Aurangzeb to recognize him as the governor of Deccan. Aurangzeb even promised to give Shambhaji (Shivaji's son) 5000 mansab. More or less, both sides came to a decision.
- Later Aurangzeb invited Shivaji Maharaj to Agra along with his son on May 1666, and he made Shivaji stand alongside the mansabdars with 5000 mansab. This came as an insult to Shivaji because the treaty was signed on an equal footing.
- ✓ It was on Amar Singh's insistence that Shivaji visited the Imperial Durbar. Being embarrassed with the treatment meted out to him, he left the court. Aurangzeb then sent his troops after Shivaji to capture him. Upon capturing him, Shivaji was put on house arrest under the vigilance of Faulad Khan.
- On his birthday, upon repeated insistence, Aurangzeb allowed Shivaji to extend alms to the poor. He had hatched a plan to flee from the fort of Agra. So going by the plan, he sat on one of the baskets carrying fruits and finally was led out of the fort under Faulad Khan's vigilance.
- Upon freeing himself, Shivaji regained his forces and his belligerent policies in 1666, and finally, in 1674, he coronated himself at Raigarh where he assumed the title of Chhatrapati. Post that, his attacks on the South became incessant.
- ✓ Shivaji signed a secret treaty with the Sultan of Golconda where he promised the Sultan to return some of his territories if the Sultan extended his support. The Carnatic campaigns added glory and prestige to the career of Shivaji Maharaj. Even the Nayaks of Madurai paid tributes to him in his honor.
- In the meanwhile, Shambhaji was locked in a fort by history because of his casual lifestyle and drinking habits. Somehow he freed himself and fled to one of the Mughal governors who had etched a plan to arrest him and send him to the court of Aurangzeb.
- ✓ Finally in 1680, Shivaji left for heavenly abode at the age of 53 but he left behind a huge empire. After him, Shambhaji became the Chhatrapati of the Marathas.

Administration of the Marathas:

- ❖ **Central level:** The administration was divided into eight departments headed by ministers who are sometimes called "Ashta Pradhan." They were:

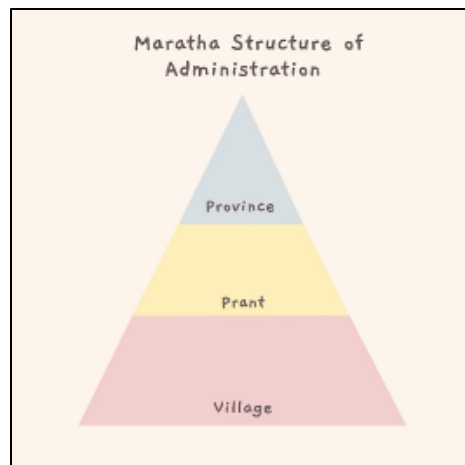
- **Peshwa:** He looked into the entire empire as the head and was the face of finance and general administration
- **Amatya:** He was the Finance Minister.
- **Waqai Navis:** An official who looked into the records of Kings and their activities.
- **Dabir or Sumant:** A foreign minister who advised the king in matters of war or peace.
- **Surnavis/Sachiv/Chitnis:** Official correspondence
- **Pandit Rao:** An individual who looked into religious affairs.
- **Nyayadish:** An individual who looked into judicial matters
- **Sari Naubat:** He was a commander-in-chief or Senapati who looked into the recruitment of the army and any other defense-related matters.

ADMINISTRATION: ASHTA PRADHAN

Minister	Functions
Mukhya Pradhan or Peshwa or Prime minister	Looked after the general welfare and interests of the State. Officiated for the king in his absence.
Amatya or Finance Minister	Checked and countersigned all public accounts of the kingdom.
Walkia-Nawis or Mantri	Maintained the records of the king's activities and the proceedings in the court.
Summant or Dabir or Foreign Secretary	Advised king on all matters of war and peace and received ambassadors and envoys from other countries.
Sachiv or Shuru Nawis or Home Secretary	Looked after the correspondence of the king with the power to revise the drafts. Checked the accounts of the Parganas.
Pandit Rao or Danadhyaksha	In charge of religion, ceremonies and charities. Judge of canon law and censor of public morals.
Nyayadhish or Chief Justice	Responsible for civil and military justice.
Sari Naubat or Commander-in-Chief	In charge of recruitment, organization and discipline of the Army.

- ❖ **Provincial Administration:** Under Shivaji, the empire was divided into 4 provinces under the charge of **governors or viceroy**. When multiple prants came together, a province was formed. The Prants were under the charge of the **subahdar**.
 - Over several Subahdar, there were Sarsubedar to **control and supervise** the work of the subedar. Smaller than prant were **Tarfs** which were headed by a **havaladar**.

- There were **Mauzas** or villages which were the lowest unit of administration.
- The territory under the direct control of the Marathas was termed '**Swaraj**'. There were other regions which remained under the indirect control of the Marathas.



Financial administration of the Maraths:

- ❖ Initially, the state demand for tax was **30%** which was later increased to **40%**. In case a famine hit the region, the farmers were given advance money and grain to cope with the situation. Later on with the normalization of the situation, this help had to be returned in the form of revenue collected from the agricultural produce itself.
- The farmers were also given easy and liberal loans for purchasing seeds and cattle. But because the area under the administration did not generate a sufficient amount of revenue they took to capturing the neighboring territories of the Mughals and Bijapur.
- ❖ The forts were the nerve centre of the prants which helped in bringing about an efficient system of administration. There was no provision for extending jagirs. Rather salary was paid in cash. In case any jagir was given, the system was not made hereditary.
- ❖ The Marathas collected **Chauth** and **Sardeshmukhi**. The former meant the collection of $\frac{1}{4}$ th of the revenue whereas the latter meant $\frac{1}{10}$ th of the revenue collected by the rulers of the areas which were captured by the Marathas, especially Bijapur and Mauryas.
 - So if the Sultan of Bijapur collected 100 rupees, 25 would be paid to the Marathas. In case of failure, the Maratha army had full authority to attack their territory and loot their riches.
 - In the collection of Sardeshmukhi, 25 rupees plus 10 rupees were collected as Shivaji Maharaj by virtue considered himself to be the Sardeshmukh or the leader of Mukhiya.

Lecture -08
Vijaynagar Empire



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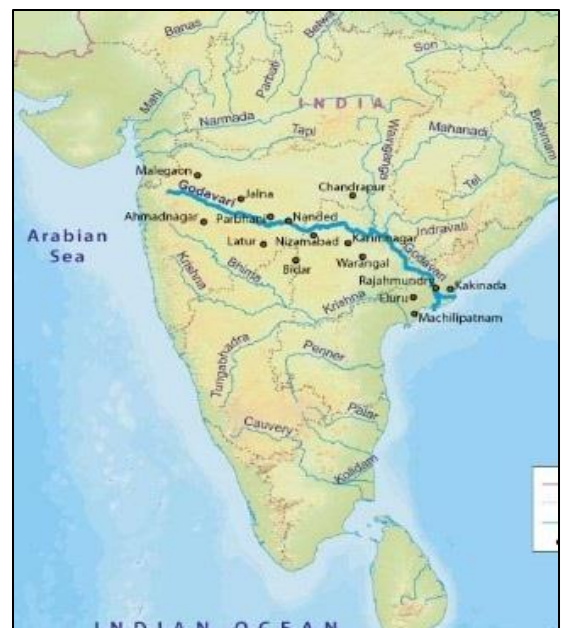
Vijaynagar Empire



- ❖ Discovery of the Vijaynagar Empire
 - Discovery of Hampi
- ❖ Establishment of the Vijaynagar Empire
- ❖ Major Dynasties of Empire
 - Contributions of Krishnadeva Raya
- ❖ Challenges Faced and Terms Associated with the Vijaynagar Empire
- ❖ The Decline of the Empire
- ❖ Administrative System of the Vijaynagar Empire
- ❖ Economy of the Vijaynagar Empire
- ❖ Capital and Royal Centre of the Vijaynagar Empire

Discovery of the Vijaynagar Empire:

- ❖ Vijayanagara or the "city of victory" was the name of both a city and an empire. The empire was founded in the 14th century CE. In its heyday, it stretched from the river Krishna in the north to the extreme south of the peninsula. In 1565 CE the city was sacked and subsequently deserted.
 - Although it fell into ruin in the 17th and 18th centuries CE, it lived on in the memories of people living in the Krishna-Tungabhadra doab.
 - They remembered it as Hampi, a name derived from that of the local mother goddess Pampadevi.
 - In today's timeline, the empire would have stretched between Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, and some parts of Andhra Pradesh



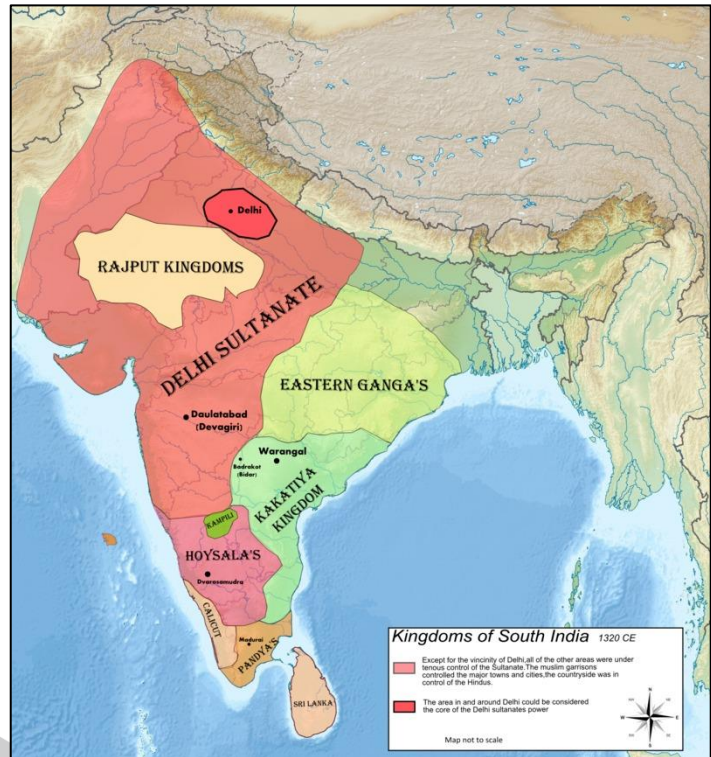
- ❖ When the British came to India officials were appointed to excavate the ruins of the empire when they heard tales about the empire. The English mostly believed in the idea of the Indian subcontinent being ruled by Muslim rulers but the fact that a Hindu empire ruled over an extensive period made them interested in excavating the unearthed history.
 - The English were very fascinated to know that the kingdom not only stretched over the mainland of India but also collected taxes from Zafna. Owing to their curiosity, in this process, they discovered Hampi.
 - Hampi's ancient ruins were uncovered in 1800 CE by Colonel Colin Mackenzie, an engineer, surveyor, and antiquarian, who created the first map of the site by gathering information from the priests at the Virupaksha temple and the Pampadevi shrine.
 - ✓ The name Hampi was derived from that of the local goddess, Pampadevi. These oral traditions combined with archaeological finds, monuments inscriptions, and other records helped scholars to rediscover the Vijayanagara Empire.
 - ✓ Further, historians combined information of Hampi Temple's inscriptions along with the records of foreign travelers and various literature written in languages like Telugu, Kannada, and Sanskrit to piece together the history of the Vijayanagara Empire.
 - ✓ The inscriptions also mentioned what Babur had commented on the Southern empire and how finally in 1565, the kingdom got weakened and subsequently deserted.
 - ✓ It was only through the inscriptions that information was gathered that even after weakening, the empire continued to rule in its dwindling position between the 16th to 17th centuries.

Establishment of the Vijaynagar Empire:

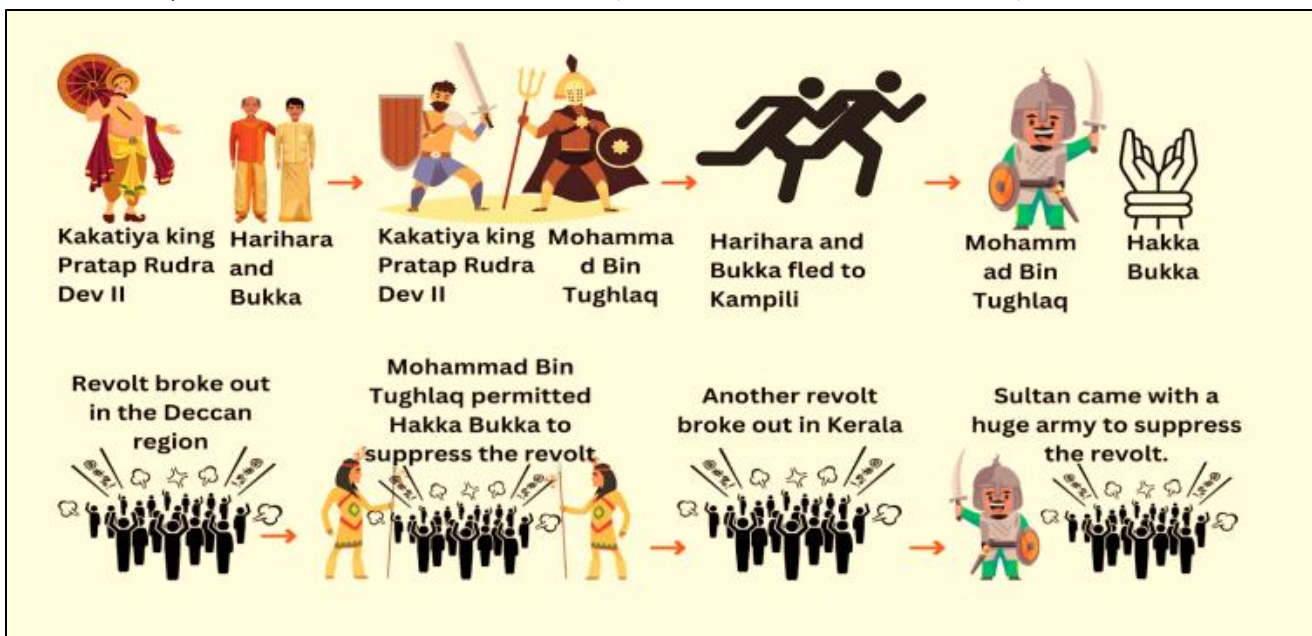
- ❖ Mohammad Bin Tughlaq aspired to conquer the entire south of India. Hence, he made efforts to attack this region. The Hoysala dynasty was a prominent South Indian dynasty that ruled over a significant part of the Deccan region, particularly the present-day Karnataka state, during the medieval period. Towards the east of the

Hoysala empire, Kakatiyas expanded their rule. In between the Hoysalas and the Kakatiya dynasty, Kampili was located.

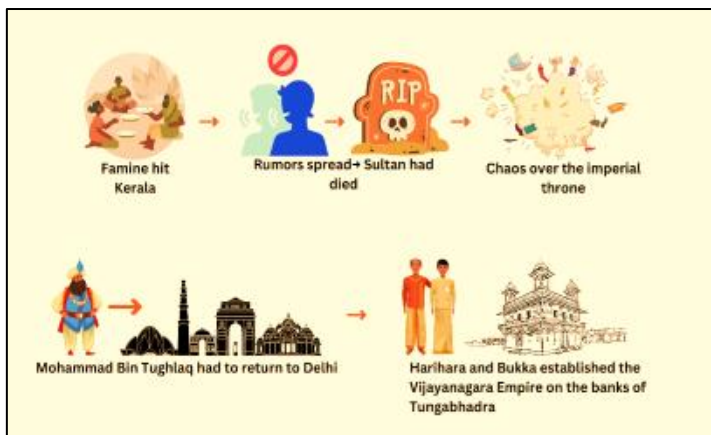
- ❖ Harihara and Bukka were feudatories of the Kakatiya king Pratap Rudra Dev II. Mohammad Bin Tughlaq first set an attack on the Kakatiya dynasty which was then being ruled by Pratap Rudra Dev II. The Kakatiyas had two famous and strong military commanders, Harihara and Bukka (Hakka-Bukka were brothers).



- Unfortunately, Pratap Rudra Dev was defeated by Mohammad Bin Tughlaq in 1323 AD (he was not a Sultan at that period but was a noble) and later captured the territories of Kakatiyas.
- After being defeated, the brothers fled away from the war front and reached Kampili and were later given the post of minister in the empire.



- ❖ Because of their arrival, Sultan Tughlaq attacked Kampili (Established by Hoysala commander, Singeya Nayaka-III in northeastern parts of present-day Karnataka). The two brothers were imprisoned upon Kampili's defeat brought to Delhi along with other prisoners, and forced to convert to Islam.
- ❖ The Hakka-Bukka brothers agreed to what the Sultan wanted and started serving the Sultanate. In the meanwhile revolt broke out in the Deccan region. So, Mohammad Bin Tughlaq was in search of some military commanders who could put a check on the chaos.
 - Considering this as a **good opportunity**, the brothers requested the Sultan to send them to the Deccan as they were **adept** with the conditions of the regions.
 - They were permitted to suppress the **revolt on behalf of the Sultan**. Successfully, law and order were restored by them. Again a revolt broke out in Kerala when Sultan Mohammad came along with a huge army to **suppress the revolt**.
 - At the same time, a **famine hit Kerala** and **rumors** were spread in the North that the **Sultan had died** in his journey so chaos was spread throughout about who would take over the **imperial throne**.
 - Mohammad Bin Tughlaq had to return to Delhi, marking a **striking incident** because there was a **huge distance** between Kerala and Delhi as it took at least two years for the entire troop to come back to the **South from Delhi**.
 - The **brothers** upon understanding the **Sultan's plight** showed their **real colours**. On the banks of Tungabhadra river, Vidyaranya Swami inspired Harihara and Bukka to establish a **Hindu kingdom** in the region.
 - ✓ It was Vidyaranya Swami who **reconverted the brothers to Hinduism** by performing purity rituals. Finally, they established the Vijaynagar empire across the river Tungabhadra around **1336**

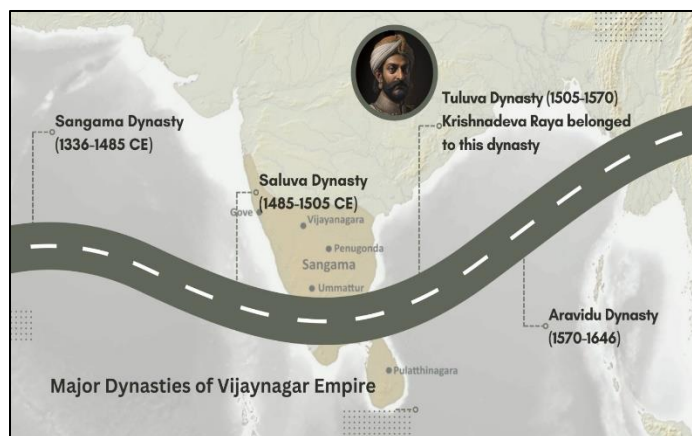


AD. It is also believed that the brothers must have named their empire against the name of their guru.

- ❖ The empire had Hoysalas on one end when the Vijaynagar empire started attacking the former. It was Haihara (1336-1356) who became the first king of the empire and Bukka assumed the position of co-regent.
 - With constant efforts, the small region across river Tungabhadra was converted into a large empire. After Harihara's demise, Bukka ascended the throne in 1356 AD. They named their dynasty as Sangama dynasty because their father's name was Bhavana Sangama.

Major Dynasties of Empire:

- ❖ Sangama Dynasty (1336-1485 CE): It was the first ruling dynasty to have continued its rule until 1485 CE. In total 5 powerful kings ruled through the dynasty's reign and came to be known as Panchsangamas. The kingdom flourished across the Tungabhadra river and gradually spread throughout the south of India.
- ❖ Saluva Dynasty (1485-1505 CE): They were the military commanders of the Sangamas who took over the throne and controlled power until 1505 CE.
- ❖ Tuluva Dynasty (1505-1570): The apogee of the empire was Krishnadeva Raya (1509-29 CE) and his empire was marked by both expansion and consolidation. In Tuzuk-e-Baburi, Babur mentioned Krishnadeva Raya. he also mentioned the latter being the most powerful king of that period.
 - The empire reached its zenith during the reign of Krishnadeva Raya. He was the only ruler who successfully acquired the land between the Tungabhadra and Krishna rivers (the Raichur doab).
 - He subdued the Gajapatis of Orissa in 1514 CE and achieved significant victories over the Sultan of Bijapur in 1520 CE. He significantly contributed to temple



construction and built impressive gopurams (gateways to temples) to several important South Indian temples.

- The period marked a timeline of unparalleled peace and prosperity. Following Krishnadeva Raya's death in 1529 CE, the empire faced internal strife, including rebellions of nayakas or military chiefs.



- ❖ **Aravidu Dynasty (1570-1646):** It was the fourth and last Hindu dynasty of the Vijayanagara Empire in South India. The Aravidu family claimed to be Kshatriyas and were based in the Andhra region. The last ruler of the Vijaynagar Empire was Sri Ranga III. Vijaynagar Empire came to an end with this.

Terms Associated with the Vijaynagar Empire:

- ❖ It was during the rule of the Vijaynagar Empire that the Bahamani kingdom was established in 1347 (after 11 years). The confrontation began between the two dynasties. At the same time, from the north, the empire had to face rivalries with the Deccan Sultans and the Gajapati rulers of Orissa.
- ❖ The Vijaynagar rulers referred to the rulers of Orissa as Gajapati meaning the lord of elephants. Deccan Sultans were referred to as Ashvapati or lord of horses.
- ❖ Rayas are called Narapati or Lord of Men and the Vijaynagar rulers termed themselves Narpati and their kings were referred to as 'Rayas'.

The Decline of the Empire:

- ❖ **Weak Successors:** The successors of Krishnadeva Raya turned out to be very weak and their administrative order too was breaking down with the Nayaks (military chiefs) rebelling against the empire. There was a shift in alliances and military ambitions among the rulers of Vijayanagara and the Deccan Sultanates led to changing geopolitical dynamics.

- ❖ **Alliance of the Deccan Sultanates**– Bijapur, Golconda, and Ahmadnagar allied against the Vijayanagar Empire, culminating in the pivotal **Battle of Rakshasi-Tangadi (or Talikota)** in 1565. Post that battle, the empire was never able to revive from the blow they received. Although the Aravidus continued to rule over a very small portion of the territory, a significant chunk of their territory was lost.



- Rama Raya, the chief minister of Vijayanagara, led the Vijayanagara army in this battle, but they suffered a **decisive defeat** at the hands of the combined armies of Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, and Golconda.

Administrative System of the Vijaynagar Empire:

- ❖ **Nayaka system:** They were military commanders who were also made responsible for overseeing the army and maintaining forts. The responsibility for the expansion of their empire was vested with them. Whenever they entered new areas, they took farmers, artisans, and traders alongside them. So more or less another empire desired to be established in the region they tried **expanding** their territories to. They frequently relocated from one region to another and sometimes rebelled.
- ❖ **Amara- Nayaka System:** It was similar to the **Iqta system** of the Delhi Sultanate. These amara-nayaks oversaw the **administration** of specific areas. They were also granted a piece of land from which **revenue** was collected and a **portion** of the revenue collected was **paid as tribute to the kings**. Even though they remained **under the King**, sometimes, both the **Nayaks** and the **Amara-Nayakas rebelled** against the order and established an **independent kingdom**.

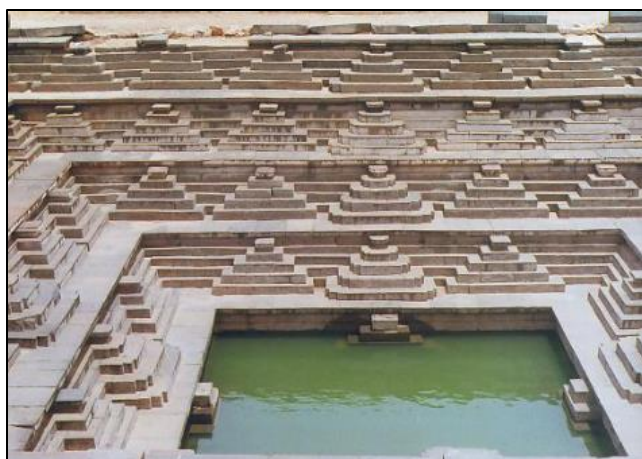


Economy of the Vijaynagar Empire:

- ❖ Trade constituted a major portion of the income owing to their *geographical location*. They traded *horses from Arabia*. The local traders who were termed *Khudrai Chettis* were experts in *horse trading*.
- ❖ Trade in *spices, textiles, and precious stones* was very common.
- ❖ *Amuktamalyada* (Telugu literature), a book written by *Krishnadeva Raya* mentioned traders.

Capital and Royal Centre of the Vijaynagar Empire:

- ❖ *Hampi* was located on the banks of the *Tugabhadra River* and from the other sites, *granite hills* enveloped the city. Thus, it was a *naturally protected city*. Even though there was natural protection, there was an *external fortification of seven layers* which were not made of *cement or mortar*. *Wedge-shaped stones* held the wall together, making it much stronger.
- ❖ Rainwater storage and its distribution to the city was also present. Famous reservoirs were: *Kamalapura Tank and Hiriya Canal*. *Great fortress walls* surrounded the entire city, enclosing agricultural lands, gardens, and houses. The walls were *massive and constructed without mortar or cement*. *Wedge-shaped stone blocks* held them in place.
- ❖ *Well-guarded gates* served as entry points, linking the city to major roads. There was an *urban center* at the core of the empire which was resided by *common people*. There was a *good supply of water* through *wells, canals, and rainwater tanks* were constructed for the easy supply of water.



❖ Portuguese traveler **Barbosa** describes houses for ordinary people, which were thatched but well-constructed, organized along lengthy streets with open spaces, and arranged according to occupation.

❖ **Royal center:** The south-west section of the empire was designated as the royal center owing to the structures of the buildings. Historians have also excavated **30** such building complexes which resemble royal palaces. A king's palace was found in this location along with **60** other temples.



➤ This resembles the religious significance and dominance of the empire. The kings attained their legitimacy from the temples they constructed.

➤ However, it was never so that the empire never allowed any other religion apart from Hinduism to flourish. Example: Krishnadeva Raya himself was a Vaishnavite. Thus, the empire was not intolerant in terms of religious development.

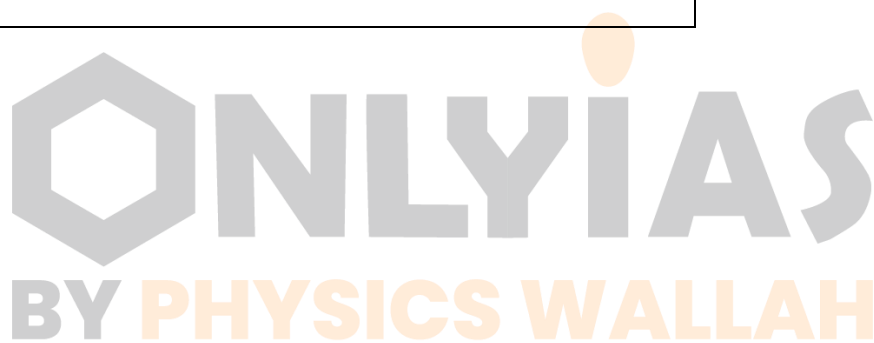
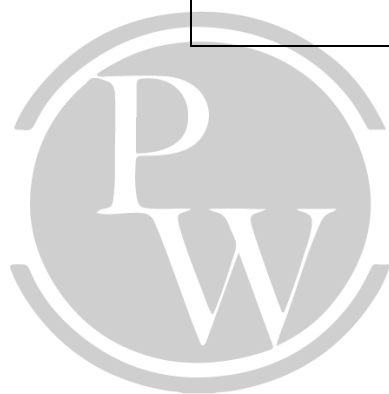
❖ “Kings-palace” is the largest of the enclosures.

❖ It has two of the most impressive platforms, usually called the audience hall and the Mahanavami Dibba. In the audience hall, there was an elevated platform with slots for wooden pillars at close and regular intervals where the king would sit and address his subjects. It had a staircase going up to the second floor, which rested on these pillars.

❖ On the occasion of Navami, a festival was organized at Mahanavami Dibba. The Mahanavmi Dibba is a massive platform located on one of the highest points in the city. It supported a wooden structure with the base of the platform covered with relief carvings.

Lecture - 09

Bahmani Kingdom



Bahmani Kingdom

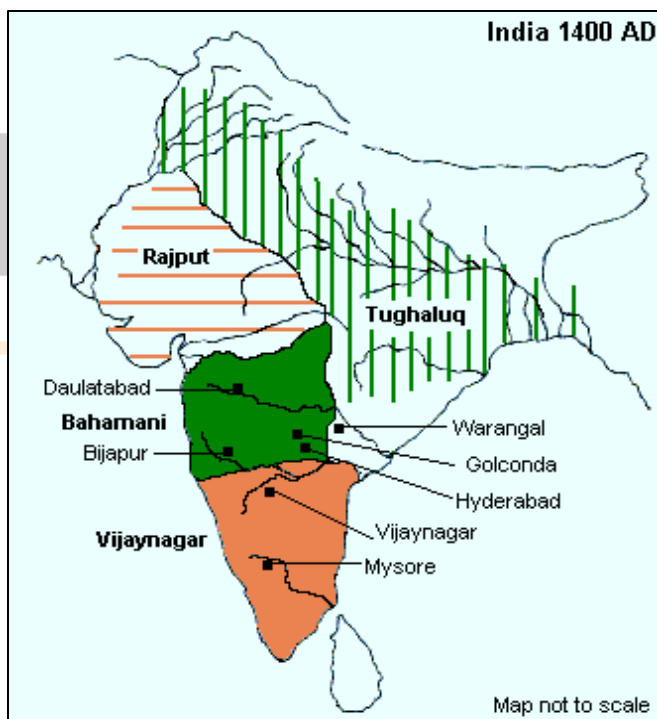


Outline of Lecture

- ❖ History of the Bahmani Kingdom (1347-1527 CE)
- ❖ The Decline of the Bahmani Kingdom
- ❖ Administration of Bahmani Kingdom

History of the Bahmani Kingdom (1347-1527 CE):

- ❖ The Bahmani Sultanate was a Persianised Muslim state of the Deccan in South India which expanded from Wainganga (a tributary of Godavari) crossing Krishna River. River Krishna marked the southern boundary of the empire and the northern boundary of the Vijaynagar empire.
 - The two empires confronted each other to gain power over the Krishna-Tungabhadra Doab or the Raichur Doab owing to the land's fertility. The Bahmani kingdom provided a cultural link between the north and south of India.
- ❖ When Mohammad Bin Tughlaq (1325-1351 AD) was ruling over Delhi, two regions separated and both Vijaynagar (1336 AD) and Bahmani kingdoms (1347 AD) developed in the south. Even Warangal was ruling over a small portion next to the Bahmanis. However the former were defeated.
- ❖ The independent Bahmani Kingdom lasted 180 years from 1347-1527 CE. Mohammad Bin Tughlaq used to set attacks on the southern territories.



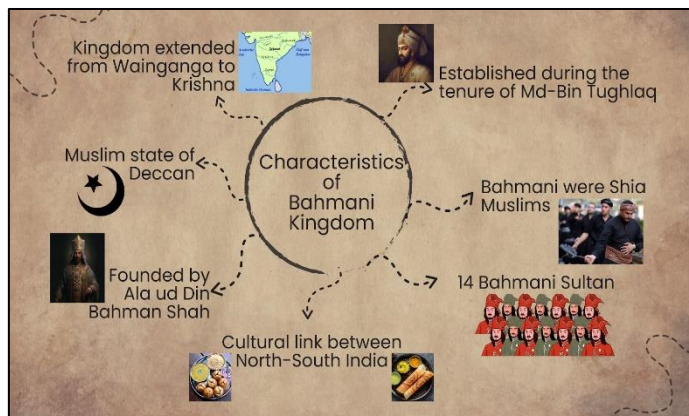
- His policy of transferring the capital from Delhi to Daulatabad caused dissatisfaction among the amirs or the nobles leading them to revolt under the leadership of Hasan Gangu popularly known as Ala-ud-Din Hasan Bahman Shah. The nobles of the Bahmani kingdom were categorized into two categories: Afaquis and Deccanis. Deccanis were nobles of native origin while Afaquis had foreign origin.



- Bahmani Kingdom was founded by Ala-ud-Din Hasan Bahman Shah in 1347 revolting against the Delhi sultanate of Mohammad Bin Tughlaq.
 - ✓ It is also believed that Hasan Gangu was brought up by a Hindu Brahmin commander Gangu. He attached Gangu to his name, owing a tribute to his patron.

- ❖ The Bahmanis were Shias, unlike the Sultanate Muslims who were Sunnis. The kingdom was founded by Ala-ud-Din Hasan Bahman Shah with the capital at Gulbarga in Karnataka. After him, Firoz Shah became the Sultan and attacked the Vijaynagar empire.
 - In the conflict, he defeated Devaraya I and got married to his daughter. Because the Bahmanis could not expand northwards (Sultanate), westwards (Arabian Sea), and eastwards (Bay of Bengal), their focus remained on southward expansion and the conflict became incessant between both the kingdoms. When Krishnadeva Rya came to power, the Bahmanis were not in a position to attack the empire under him.

- After Firoz Shah, Ahmed Shah Wali came to power. Under him, the capital placed at Gulbarga was shifted to Bidar owing to its central location. Even though he was closely inclined towards Sufism, he was one of the most treacherous and cruel sultans to have ruled through the Bahmani kingdom.



- After Ahmed Shah Wali, Muhammad Shah III became the sultan at the age of 9 after the death of his brother Nizam Shah. Mahmud Gawan served as Prime Minister and Muhammad Shah III's regent. In total, there were 14 Bahmani sultans but the Empire reached its zenith during the time of Mahmud Gawan, a minister of the Empire.
- Mahmud Gawan was an Iranian trader and Gawan was the name of his village. He was favored by the amirs because of the successful business relations he had established.
 - ✓ He was granted the title of Malik-ul-Tujjar (Chiefs of Merchants or Traders) by Humayun Shah. For almost 20 years he dominated the state affairs of the Bahamani. Under his leadership, the Bahamani kingdom saw a resurgence.
 - ✓ He was Iranian by birth and was a trader. He divided the kingdom into eight provinces called Tarafs (provinces). Each Taraf was governed by the Tarafdar. The salary was paid in cash or by assigning a Jagir.
 - ✓ Under him, a tract of land called Khalisa was set apart for the expenses of the Sultan.
 - ✓ It was Gawan who introduced the use of gunpowder in the war against Vijaynagar Kings. Gunpowder was discovered by the Chinese in the 13th century. He built a college at Bidar using Persian-style architecture.
 - ✓ Unfortunately, Gawan was executed in 1481 by Muhammad Shah along with the Deccan nobles who plotted against him.

- After Gawan's execution, no noble could understand or restructure the administration and the revenue model set up by Mahmud Gawan. Their treacherous plan proved to be the cause of the empire's demise. Until his death, Mohammad Shah continued regretting and grieving the crime he had committed by executing his regent.
- Kalimullah was the last king of the Bahmani dynasty. After him, the capital at Bidar too got separated. Thus, the prosperous empire fell and got divided into multiple smaller kingdoms as the nobles divided the empire amongst themselves:
 - ✓ The Adil Shahi Dynasty of Bijapur founded by Yusuf Adilshah (1489-90)
 - ✓ The Nizam Shahi Dynasty of Ahmednagar founded by Malik Ahmad (1499)
 - ✓ The Imadshahi Dynasty of Berar founded by Fateh Ulla Imadshanti (1490)
 - ✓ The Qutubshahi kingdom of Golconda founded by Qutabshah (1512)
 - ✓ The Baridshahi Dynasty of Bidar founded by Amir Ali Barid (1527).

The Decline of the Bahmani Kingdom:

- ❖ Most of the Bahmani rulers were tyrants, thus unable to understand the importance of an efficient system of administration apart from Mahmud Gawan. They mostly remained busy fighting among themselves, and after Mahmud Gawan, no such representative came to the throne who could hold the strings of the empire.
- ❖ Struggle with the neighboring Hindu Kingdoms, particularly the Vijayanagar Empire.
- ❖ Incompetent and weak successors after Muhammad Shah III finally led to the disintegration of the empire into multiple dynasties that were later captured by the Mughals.
- ❖ Rivalry and contestation between the Bahmani rulers and nobles was on a constant rise.
- ❖ Rise in court politics between Deccanis (Locals) & Afaqis (Northerners, Afghanis, Turks).

Administration of Bahmani Kingdom:

- ❖ The first ruler of the kingdom, Bahman Shah did not get much time to look after the administration as he mostly remained busy fighting.

- ❖ Muhammad Tughluq who had divided his territories in the Deccan into four provinces was kept intact by Bahman Shah as it was except that he appointed his officers everywhere.
- ❖ Muhammad Shah I divided the kingdom into four Tarafs (provinces) whose capitals were Daultabad, Berar, Bidar, and Gulbarga respectively. Provincial governors called Tarfdars with extensive administrative and military powers were appointed in each of these provinces.

 - Tarafdar collected revenue from his province, organized the provincial army, and appointed all civil and military officers of his province. Sometimes Tarfdars were appointed ministers of the king as well.
- ❖ When the kingdom became further extensive and Mahmud Gavan worked as prime minister, the number of provinces was raised from four to eight.
 - Mahmud Gavan attempted to restrict the powers of provincial governors and, for that purpose, fixed some land as the land of the Sultan in each province which was managed by the officers of the central government.
- ❖ The head of the state was the Sultan who enjoyed all executive, legislative, and judicial powers within the state.
- ❖ At the highest level of administration, Tarafs were positioned. Below the tarafs were sarkars, parganas, and villages down the scale.
- ❖ In terms of judicial powers, the Sultan was the chief judicial officer, he also availed the title of Sadr-i-Jahr. Other judicial officers functioned under him.
- ❖ There was a large standing army headed by the Sultan. The head of the army after the Sultan was called the Amir-ul-Umrah. The Sultan had his bodyguards who were known as Khas-e-Khel.

- ❖ *Shihabuddin Ahmad I* introduced the *Mansabdari* system in the army. At times, the military officials and civilian officers were given *mansabs* to fix up their salaries.
 - *Jagirs* were attached by the mansabs from which *revenue* was collected and the expenses to carry out the *administration* of these *respective territories* were carried out from the *revenue collected*. The *Jagirdars* were required to submit a statement of their income and expenditure to the Central Government.



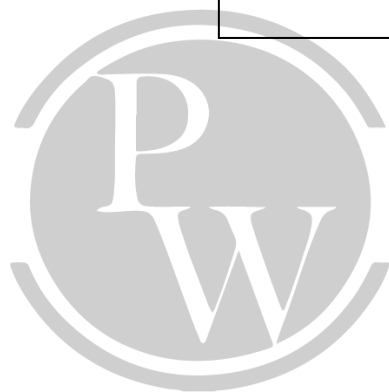
Cultural Development under the Bahmani Empire:

- ❖ The Sultans supported language, literature, music, and the arts in addition to architecture. Under their support, Urdu gained momentum.
- ❖ Persian was replaced as the court tongue by Dakhini by Ibrahim Adil Shah. the architecture of the period had a great influence on Persian architecture. Example: Gol Gumbaz at Bijapur is the mausoleum of Muhammad Adil Shah.
- ❖ Mohammad Gawan wrote poems in the Persian language. *Riyaz-ul-Insha*, and *Manazir-ul-insha* are his works.



ONLYIAS
BY PHYSICS WALLAH

Lecture - 10
Sufi Movement



ONLYIAS
BY PHYSICS WALLAH

Sufi Movement



Outline of Lecture

- ❖ Religion in the Bahamani Kingdom
- ❖ Introduction to Bhakti or Devotion
- ❖ Meaning of the Sufi Movement
 - The Origin of Sufism
 - Reasons behind the Rise of Sufism within Islam
 - Types of Sufi Order
 - Seven Valleys of Sufism
 - Silsilas

Religion in the Bahamani Kingdom:

- ❖ The Bahamani Kingdom helped in the growth of Muslim culture in south India. Followers of Islam in north India and foreign countries established themselves in the Bahamni Kingdom.
- ❖ Different rulers patronized Muslim scholars and religious preachers. Even after the disintegration of the Bahamani Kingdom, the rulers of those states that arose on the ruins of it patronized Muslim saints, scholars, artists, etc, and constructed madrasas.
- ❖ The conflict with the Hindu rulers of South India also forced the rulers of the Bahamani Kingdom to provide political and cultural leadership to Islam in the South.

Introduction to Bhakti or Devotion:

- ❖ There was a wave of spiritualism between the 14th-15th centuries because of which the Bhakti movement & Sufism flourished.
- ❖ To attain god, an individual must have proper knowledge, believe in good actions, have good conduct throughout, and dedicate oneself to God. Devoting oneself to God is the easiest way to attain spiritualism.
- ❖ The devotion one had for Allah paved a path towards the Sufi movement. When an individual from Hinduism devoted himself/herself to God, it gave rise to the Bhakti

movement. Thus, Sufism is also a means to attain Allah. Sufism aims at establishing direct communion between god and man through personal surrender and spiritual love.

Meaning of the Sufi Movement:

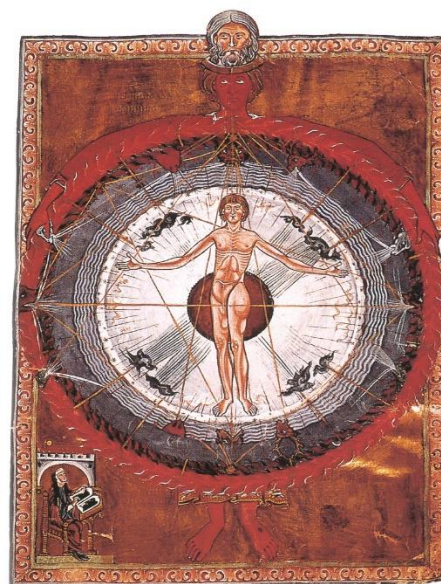
- ❖ The Medieval period is considered an age of great cultural synthesis in India/ Indo-Islamic culture.
- ❖ The first theory regarding the origins of the term Sufism can be traced to the lifetime of the Prophet Muhammad (Paigamber Muhammed), whose teachings attracted a group of scholars engaged in discussions regarding – Who are we, what is the purpose of our existence, what have we done till now, etc.
 - These men came to be called "Ahle Suffe", the People of Suffe, from their practice of sitting at the platform of the mosque of the Prophet in Medina. When these scholars through their devotion tried attaining Allah, it came to be known as the Sufi movement.
- ❖ The second interpretation owing to the origin of the term relates to the person who wears Safa clothes and is called a Sufi saint.
 - Safa' means wool or wool cloth made of goat or sheep hair. It is a rough, thick & low-quality cloth. The wearing of Safa is an expression against materialism or a departure from any aspect of materialism.



The Origin of Sufism:

- ❖ It had its origin in Persia and later it spread to India in the 11th century. The aspects of yogic postures, dance, and music were also adopted into it. This was a sway away from the orthodoxy in Islam because music, dance, and many other practices were haram in Islam (forbidden or unlawful). However, due to assimilation with the native Indian culture, such practices were adopted.
- ❖ Mansoor Hallaj, Persian mystic, poet, and teacher of Sufism of the 9th century, was the first Sufi saint who declared himself Analahaka similar to what is said in Hinduism—
मैं सत्य हूँ। मैं ब्रह्मन हूँ.

- ❖ Al Ghazzali, a Persian philosopher of the 11th century, gave Sufism a respectable identity in the Muslim world. He made Sufism a separate sect within Islam because he did not follow the fundamentals of Islam.
- ❖ The first Sufi saint in India was Sheikh Ali al-Hujwiri. He was an 11th-century Persian Sufi Saint. When Mohammad Ghorri attacked India, Sheikh Muinuddin Chishti came along with him.



Reasons behind the Rise of Sufism within Islam:

- ❖ **Mystic Consciousness Developed in Islam:** In general it is understood that a direct link between an individual and God is not possible without the interference of a third party. This is a general concept in majority religion.
 - In Hinduism, we have brahmins, pandits, and purohits which show us the way to God. Similarly in Christianity, Popes and clergy are dominant and claim to be the representatives of God who would ultimately guide the way towards the almighty. In Islam, too Ulemas are present who claim the same. Thus, mediators are present in all three sections but in Sufism, mysticism states that there is **no need** for a mediator to attain God nor there is a need for a book.
 - ✓ Thus one's relation with the almighty or God would remain a mystery. This idea of mystery turned out to be very endearing to individuals because of this there was an increase in individuals' faith in Sufism.
- ❖ **Increasing Atrocities of Ulemas:** These ulemas used to interpret and explain laws and codes of the Quran and Shariat as per their whims and fancies which made Islam a very conservative and rigid religion.
- ❖ **Rise of Orthodoxy in Islam:** Orthodoxy simply means sticking to the fundamentals of a religion. Orthodoxy in Islam rested on stringent practices and made dance and music haram. But, Sufim gave individuals a sense of freedom from all the atrocious practices in Islam.

- ❖ **Rise of Materialism:** Materialism simply means love for worldly matters. Sufism arose at a time when the world was becoming more and more materialistic and individuals started giving up on spirituality. This is when Sufism rose and a shift took place from materialism to spiritualism once and for all again.
- ❖ **Dissatisfaction Among the People:** Islamic principles were harsh because of which individuals were dissatisfied. Sufism gave a sense of openness and freedom leading to the mass attraction of the population.

Types of Sufi Order:

- ❖ There were two types of Sufi order: **Be-Shara** and **Ba-Shara**. Shara stands for the Islamic law (Sharia).
 - **Ba-shara** obeyed the laws of Shariyat & had a conservative attitude.
 - **Be-shara** did not follow Shariat law & had a flexible approach and attitude. It was a liberal sect of Sufism.
 - Shariyat was a law book that contained laws to control human conduct. If the regulations and rules of Shariyat were not followed, the individuals would be vehemently punished.

Concept of Valleys in Sufism or the Fundamental Principles of Sufism:

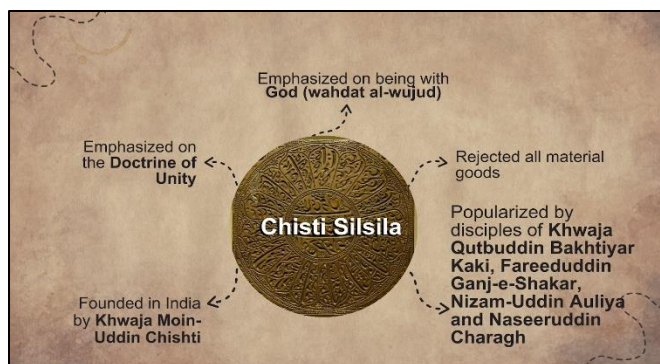
- ❖ Sufis preached monotheism or belief in one God. To attain God, one must cross seven valleys. These valleys were:
 - **Valley of Search:** It means to cleanse one's heart. Upon cleansing one's heart, the first step to attain god was taken.
 - **Valley of Love:** It states that love burns away the reason, causing pain, madness, and single-minded endeavor. The inquisitiveness about the reason behind finding god would never help one in finding God.
 - **Valley of Knowledge:** It does not pertain to our generic understanding of knowledge rather it is the knowledge of God. It states the ways to attain god and is not one based on learning
 - **Valley of Unity:** It refers to everything we have in our surroundings are the attributes of God irrespective of one's religion. Every individual is alike.
 - **Valley of Contentment:** It stresses being independent of worldly affairs

- **Valley of Wonderment:** It focuses on the *Seeker*, who is struck dumb (mute) by the beauty of God.
- **Valley of True Poverty and Absolute Nothingness:** It is the one in which the seeker is poor by giving up on all the worldly material things but is rich in spiritual attributes.

Silsilas:

- ❖ The *Piri Muridi* system which is more or less similar to *Guru Shishya Parampara* was prevalently practised in Sufism. *Piri* came from the word *Pir* which meant *Guru* and *Muridi* came from the word *Murid* which meant *shishya*.
 - The *Pirs* extend his knowledge to the *Murid* who in turn is in search of God. To attain God, *Murid* needs to let go of his worldly affairs. In this approach, the *Pir* would help his *Murid* in freeing himself from the materialistic world.
 - Each *Pir* would have many *Murids* and the *Pir's* idea would be circulated over time. The *Murids* themselves would become *Pirs*. In this way, the philosophy of each *Pir* would be rolled on continuously. This is referred to as *Silsila*.
- ❖ There were twelve *pirs* in total which gave rise to Sufis being divided into 12 *Silsilas*. The head of each *Silsila* was a mystic who lived in *Khanqah* (ashram) with his disciples (*Murid*). The guidance of *Pir* (*Guru*) and the love bond between *Pir & Murid* (disciple) were the basis of salvation. The seeker's goal is to move from human love to divine love. *Guru* helps achieve this goal.
- ❖ *Chishti* and *Suhrawardi* became more prevalent in the North India. Both were 'Be-Shara' *Silsilas* who did not obey the laws of *Sharia*. The four most important Sufi *silsilas* which emerged in India were:
 - **Chisti Silsila:** The *Chishtiya* Order was founded in India by *Khwaja Moin-Uddin Chishti*. It emphasized the doctrine of unity of being with God (*wahdat al-wujud*) and members of the order were also pacifists.
 - ✓ They rejected all material goods as distractions from the contemplation of God.
 - ✓ They abstained from connection with the secular state, kings, and donations of the State.

- ✓ Recitation of the names of God, both aloud and silently. The Chishti teachings were carried forward and popularized by disciples of Khwaja Moin-Uddin Chishti like Khwaja Qutbuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki, Fareeduddin

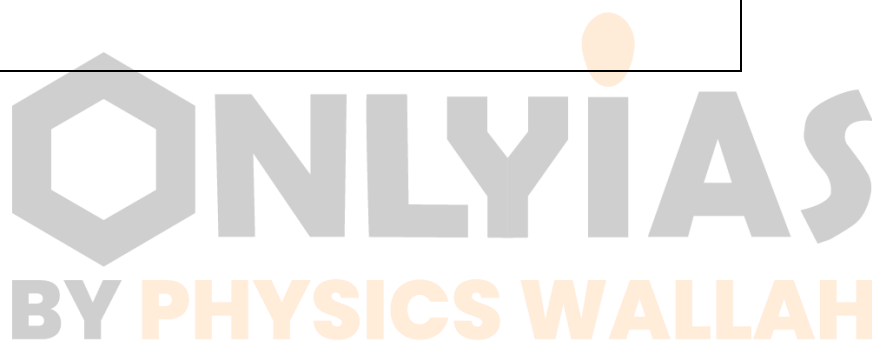
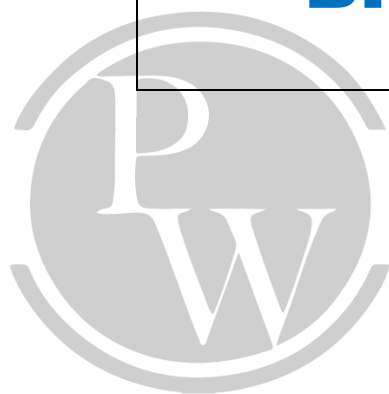


Ganj-e-Shakar, Nizam-Uddin Auliya and Naseeruddin Charagh.

- It was Nizam-Uddin Auliya who cursed Ghiyas-ud-Din Tughlaq that he would never be able to reach Delhi. In his way, the latter died too.
- **Suhrawardi Order:** It was founded by Sheikh Shahabuddin Suhrawardi.
 - ✓ The saints of this order accepted maintenance grants from the Sultans and were involved in politics.
- **Naqshbandi Order:** Khwaja Baha-ul-din Naqsh who started the order, stressed the observance of the Shariat.
 - ✓ This order was popularized in India by Babur who was deeply devoted to Naqshbandiyya leader Khwaja Ubaidullah Ahrar. One of the disciples of Khwaja was Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi who opposed all those practices and beliefs of Akbar and demanded the re-imposition of Jizyah.
- **Qadiriyya Order:** It was started by Sheikh Abdul Qadir of Badaun and was made popular in Punjab.
 - ✓ This order attained supporters of the Mughals under Akbar.
 - ✓ The adherents of this order supported the Wahdat al Wujud concept. The term Wahdat-al-Wajood, which implies that God and his creation are the same, means "Unity of Existence" or "Unity of Being," and Qadris adhered to this belief.

Lecture -11

Bhakti Movement



Bhakti Movement



Outline of Lecture

- ❖ Origin of the Bhakti Movement
- ❖ Beginning of the Bhakti Movement in the South and North of India
- ❖ Reasons behind the Rise of the Bhakti Movement
 - In South India between 7th and 9th centuries
 - In North India between 14th and 17th centuries
- ❖ Sects in the Bhakti Movement in the South of India
- ❖ Sects in the Bhakti Movement in the North of India
- ❖ Saints of Bhakti Movement

Origin of the Bhakti Movement:

- ❖ It is said that when the Guptas (4th century CE) ruled over parts of Northern India, the elements of the Bhakti Movement started evolving. The concept of Bhagwatism which developed in the Gupta period involved the worship of Lord Vishnu or an Avatar of Krishna, thus highlighting the element of Bhakti. But this cannot be considered as the beginning of the Bhakti movement.
- ❖ It was only in the Southern part of India that the Bhakti Movement originated in the 7th-9th century in the ancient Tamil, (now parts of Tamil Nadu and Kerala), and then it started spreading throughout North India. Initially, Bhakti had its roots in Vedas & Upnishadas.
- ❖ Gradually spreading its roots, in North India, the Bhakti Movement peaked between the 14th century and the 17th century CE.

Beginning of the Bhakti Movement in the South and North of India:

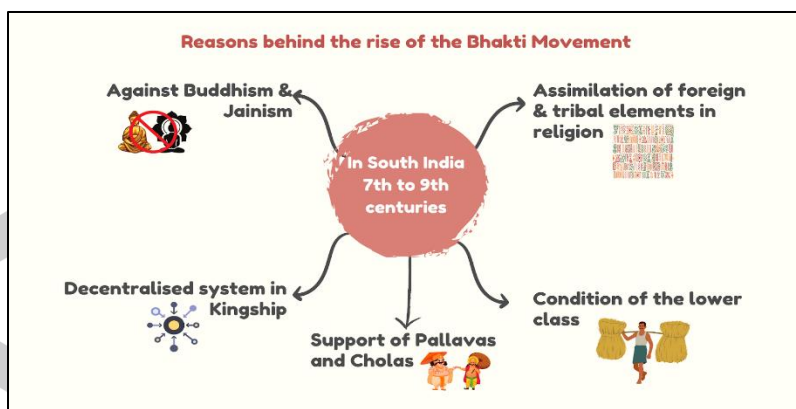
- ❖ **South India:** The movement took its shape in Tamilnadu. The development took place in South India when the Nayanars and Alwars moved against the austerities propagated by the Buddhist and Jain schools & professed that ultimate devotion to god was a means to salvation.

- Bhakti was accepted as a means to attain moksha along with jnana and karma.
- The Alvars were the devotees of Lord Vishnu and the Nayanars were the devotees of Lord Shiva.
- The movement was first headed by the Alvars and then carried forward by the Nayanars.
- ❖ North India: In the northern parts, the movement that commenced between the 14th and 17th centuries was started by Ramananda and his disciples.

Reasons behind the rise of the Bhakti Movement:

- ❖ In South India between the 7th and 9th centuries:

- Decentralised System in Kinship: Feudal structure or the decentralized structure created a favorable environment for the Bhakti sect & Shakti sect.



- ✓ Multiple minor lords or governors under the kings were given land grants and the right to govern those areas independently. These lords then gave place to the Bhakti saints and extended their support to the beginning of the movement.
- **Against Buddhism & Jainism:** To put a check on the rising influence and austerities of both Buddhism and Jainism, the Bhakti movement was started.
- **Assimilation of Foreign & Tribal Elements in Religion:** The foreign elements were infiltrating the society, hampering the core idea of Hinduism.
 - ✓ Chinese, Hunas, and other foreign infiltrators came in the subcontinent and began their ritualistic practices. They began worshipping their native gods and goddesses sidelining the prominence that Hinduism once held.
- **Condition of the Lower Class:** The lower class needed console due to harsh social & economic conditions as they were not getting their due position within Hinduism. This made them swayed toward the egalitarian structure of Buddhism and Jainism.

✓ So to stop these people from converting themselves, the Bhakti movement allowed them to keep their original belief system intact without being segregated.

❖ **Support of Pallavas and Cholas:** The Pallava & Chola rulers needed validity for rule from the people. So to gain prominence, they extended their support to the Bhakti saints.

❖ **In North India between the 14th and 17th centuries:**

➤ **Invasion of Muslim Power:** Islamic invasion had already begun with the attack of Mohammad Ghori. He began spreading the Islamic traditions and the population was being made to bend towards Islam. Already Buddhism and Jainism dominated the region owing to their egalitarian structure and less stringency in terms of traditions and practises, Hinduism once again was getting sidelined. Now to save the religion from completely vanishing, the Bhakti movement was started.

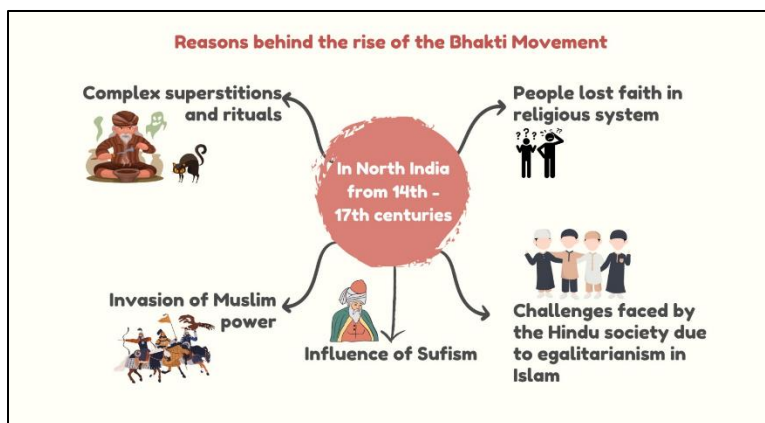
➤ **Complex Superstitions and Rituals:** The complexity of Hinduism was difficult for people to comprehend. Taking this as a base, Buddhists stressed their idea of Madhyam Marga and the Jains propounded the idea of truth, ahimsa, and salvation.

✓ Islam too appealed to the crowd owing to their belief in one God. This caused a diversion of masses away from Hinduism.

✓ This is where the Bhakti saints came to the rescue and insisted on the sole worship of God without the need of a mediator, eliminating the increasing influence of Buddhism, Jainism, and Islam. It

wouldn't be wrong to state that the Bhakti saints rescued Hinduism.

➤ **People Lost Faith in their Religious System:** When the Muslim invaders invaded India, they destroyed the temples and the idols. Contrary to the belief of people



that their Gods and Goddesses would rescue themselves from the attack, only vandalism was witnessed.

- ✓ Here the Nirguna sect played a very important role where it was propounded that God was formless and there was no such necessity to visit temples to establish direct contact with the almighty. The idea of mysticism was stressed which helped these people regain their faith in Hinduism.
- **Challenges Faced by the Hindu Society due to Egalitarianism and brotherhood in Islam:** It was propounded that until Islam came to South Asia, the caste system was not prevalent in Islam. This too attracted people towards Islam but here the Bhakti movement provided unity and egalitarianism in Hinduism and restricted the Hindus from being influenced by Islam.
- **Influence of Sufism:** The element of mysticism of the Sufi movement infiltrated within the Bhakti movement in both the North and South of India.

Sects in the Bhakti Movement in the South of India:

- ❖ The Alvars and Nayanars emerged from the region of Tamil Nadu.
- ❖ The groups of Alvars (saints devoted to Vishnu) and Nayanars (saints devoted to Shiva), consisted of people from all castes including those considered "untouchable" like the Pulaiyar and the Panars were included.
- ❖ **Alvars:**
 - The Alvars were sharply critiques of the Buddhists and Jainas.
 - There were 12 Alvars who were Tamil poet-saints.
 - One of the most prominent books of the Alvars was the Divya Prabandha which was a collection of Bhakti songs.
- ❖ **Nayanars:**
 - They were staunch critiques of Buddhism, Jainism along with the Alvars.
 - There were 63 Nayanars saints.

 Nayanars	 Alvars
• Devotees of Shiva • Critiques of Buddhism, Jainism and the Alvars • 63 Nayanars in total • Prominent book- Tevaram	• Devotees of Vishnu • Critiques of Buddhism and Jainism • 12 Alvars in total • Prominent book- Divya Prabandha

- Tevaram was a book that had a collection of songs of Nayanars, compiled and classified in the 10th century by Appar, Sambandar, and Sundarar.
- One saint "Appar" is said to have converted Pallava King Mahendravarman to Saivism.
- ❖ These 63 Nayanar saints, along with the 12 Alvars are known as South India's 75 Apostles of Bhakti movement.



About Adi Shankaracharya:

- ❖ One of the most important thinkers in Hinduism is regarded as Shankaracharya. It was up to him to define and systematize religion as it exists now.
- ❖ Additionally, he helped to shape Advaita Vedanta, a branch of Hindu philosophy that emphasizes the unity of all reality and non-duality.
- ❖ He was born in the early years of the Bhakti movement. In addition to promoting the path of devotion, or bhakti marga, as a means of achieving spiritual elevation, his core teachings centered on self-knowledge and non-dualism.
- ❖ **Advaita Vedanta: The Philosophy of Non-Dualism**
 - The Advaita Vedanta school of philosophy is grounded in the belief that the individual self (atman) and the ultimate reality (Brahman) are one and the same. This belief is based on the Upanishads, a collection of Hindu scriptures that are considered to be the most authoritative texts in the Hindu tradition.

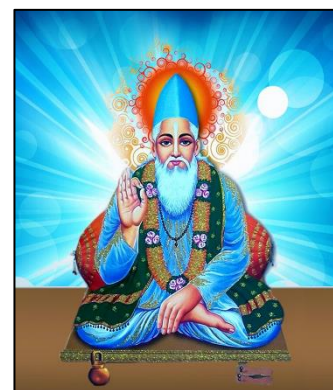
Sects in the Bhakti Movement in the North of India:

- ❖ Based on how the saints perceived the presence of God, the Bhakti saints were separated into two schools:
 - **Nirguna Sect:** According to this philosophical perspective, God is formless without any distinguishing attributes. This ideological movement is known as the Nirguna School. This school stressed two paths: Path of Knowledge and Path of Devotion.

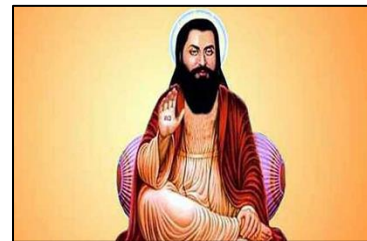
- ✓ Following the Path of Knowledge, Kabir Das, Raidas, and Guru Nanak spread the Bhakti Movement.
- ✓ From the Path of Devotion, we have Malik Muhammad Jayisi and other Sufis.
- **Saguna Sect:** The Saguna School holds that God exists and takes on specific attributes, including that of Rama and Krishna. Commitment and affection are highly valued in the Saguna School.
- ✓ The Saguna Bhakti School was divided into two groups: The devotees of Ram Bhakti (Tulsidas who wrote Ramcharitamanas) and the devotees of Krishna Bhakti (Suradas).

Saints of Bhakti Movement:

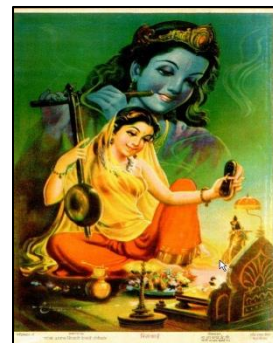
- ❖ **Ramananda:** He was the first Bhakti saint and founder of the Bhakti Movement of northern India. He was born at Prayagraj (Allahabad) but got his education from Varanasi.
 - He preached in a vernacular medium (spoke in Awadhi with the locals) to propagate his ideas. He opposed the caste system, preached equality, and chose his disciples from all sections of society irrespective of caste.
 - Kabir and Raidas who were Ramananda's disciples came from the families of weavers and cobblers respectively. This highlights his following the idea of equality he preached about.
- ❖ **Kabir:** He was the most famous disciple of Ramananda who belonged to the Nirguna sect. He was brought up by a Muslim couple who were weavers by profession but was born to a Hindu mother who had abandoned him.
 - Kabir stood for doing away with all the unnecessary customs and rituals in Hindu and Muslim religions and bringing union between these religions.
 - Bijak, Sakhi Granth, Kabir Granthawali, and Anurag Sagar are a few of his compositions.



- ❖ **Ravidas or Raidas:** He was another Nirguna Bhakta disciple of Ramananda who belonged to a family of leather workers. His verses found a place in *Guru Granth Sahib*, the holy text of Sikhism. Mirabai, a Rajput lady of a royal family of Rajasthan, was one of the followers of Ravidas.



- ❖ **Mirabai:** She was a Saguna Bhakti saint from the 16th century. Before becoming a saint, she was a Rajput princess who got married to Bhojraj Singh Sisodia, the eldest son of Rana Sangha, ruler of Mewar.



- She became popular in Rajasthan for her bhajans. "Paayoji maine Ram Ratan dhan paayo" (पायो जी मैंने राम रतन धन पायो)

She was a devotee of Krishna and left the imperial palace to renounce worldly ties.

- ❖ **Surdas:** Belonging to the Krishna Bhakti cult, he popularized the Krishna cult. He composed the *Sur Sagar* in Braj Bhasha. Even Surdas' compositions are found in the *Guru Granth Sahib*.
- ❖ **Tulsidas:** He was a worshipper of Rama. A few of his works, *Ramcharitmanas*, and *Ramlala Nahachhu* were written in Awadhi. His compositions in Brajabhasha included *Gitavali*, *Dohavali*, and *Vinaya Patrika*.

Importance of the Bhakti Movement:

- ❖ The Bhakti movement provided a spur for the development of regional languages such as Hindi, Marathi, Bengali, Kannada, etc.
- ❖ The lower classes rose to a position of great importance.
- ❖ The Bhakti movement gave equal importance to men and women which gave way to the importance of women in society.
- ❖ Established harmony among the classes, caste groups & religions.

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